

BNM-021

Introduction to Journalism and Digital Media

Block

2

JOURNALISM AND MEDIA IN THE DIGITAL AGE

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BLOCK 2 JOURNALISM AND MEDIA IN THE DIGITAL AGE

In **Block 2, Journalism and Media in the Digital Age**, we will explore the multifaceted landscape of journalism and its evolving nature and types. We will delve into the intricate relationship between technology, society, and the Fourth Estate, understanding how digital advancements impact the media landscape. Examining the crucial role of the Fourth Estate in democracy, we'll analyse its challenges and responsibilities. Next, we'll embrace Mobile Journalism, a cutting-edge approach to reporting, and investigate how technology empowers media while facing potential restrictions. Lastly, we'll explore the fascinating world of Algorithms and AI for Journalism, delving into their influence on media practices and the future of reporting.

Unit 5, on Journalism: Natures and Types, we will delve into the core aspects of journalism, exploring its nature, different types, and the ethical principles that guide it. Additionally, we will examine the diverse ownership patterns within the media landscape, gaining insights into the dynamic interplay between media organisations and society.

In **Unit 6, Technology, Society and the Fourth Estate**, we provide an in-depth overview of the symbiotic relationship between society and technology. We delve into the concept, origin, and significance of the Fourth Estate as a vital pillar of democracy. Unravelling the Socio-Technical Interface, we analyse the impact of technology on media and society through the Socio-Technical Systems Model. Further, we explore the growth and development of the Fourth Estate, including its presence in print media (newspapers), broadcast media, and new media platforms.

In **Unit 7, Democracy and the Fourth Estate**, we delve into the foundational concept of democracy and its significance. We introduce the Four Pillars of Democracy and focus on the crucial role of the Fourth Estate. Understanding the essential right of Freedom of the Press, we explore how the Constitution shapes media freedom. Delving into the roles and responsibilities of the press, we examine its vital role in upholding democratic values. Lastly, we address the challenges posed by attacks that aim to curtail press freedom, emphasising the importance of preserving free and independent media in democratic societies.

In **Unit 8, on Mobile Journalism**, we explore the dynamic world of mobile journalism and its significance in citizen reporting. We dive into mobile journalism's strengths and production aspects, equipping you with essential tools and applications. However, we also address the challenges faced, including ethical concerns surrounding credibility, fake news, and sensitivity.

Unit 9, on Technological Empowerment and Muzzled Press, we explore the transformative impact of technology on the media industry. We define technological empowerment and analyse its implications for media organisations. Comparing technological empowerment to media practices, we unravel the unique dynamics within the industry. Additionally, we delve into

the concept of a muzzled press, examining the challenges that media faces in the digital age.

In **Unit 10, Algorithms and AI for Journalism**, we delve into the cutting-edge world of emerging media technology. We explore technological determinism and the evolution of new media. Investigating algorithms in media, we define and assess AI algorithms' strengths and weaknesses. Further, we examine the significant role of artificial intelligence in journalism, including AI-powered writing and news presenters. Equipping journalists with technological skills, we address the importance of AI ethics in the media. Lastly, we introduce powerful AI tools, such as Chat GPT, Jasper AI, and Quillbot, and analyse AI's impact on journalism's future.

These six units offer an in-depth overview of the vital role and responsibilities of journalists and news organisations in our societal contexts. In addition, you will gain insights into the technological influences on journalism and its practices. This block provides a comprehensive understanding of the amalgamation of news practices, social responsibilities, and technological innovations that shape the functioning of modern journalism.



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UNIT 5 JOURNALISM: NATURE AND TYPES

Structure

- 5.0 Introduction
- 5.1 Learning Outcomes
- 5.2 Nature of Journalism
- 5.3 Ownership Pattern of Media
- 5.4 Journalistic Ethics
- 5.5 Types of Journalism
 - 5.5.1 Radio Journalism
 - 5.5.2 Television Journalism
 - 5.5.3 Online Journalism
 - 5.5.4 Photojournalism
 - 5.5.5 Print Journalism
- 5.6 Genres of Journalism
 - 5.6.1 Sports Journalism
 - 5.6.2 Science Journalism
 - 5.6.3 Civic Journalism
 - 5.6.4 Business Journalism
 - 5.6.5 Entertainment Journalism
- 5.7 Let Us Sum Up
- 5.8 Further Reading
- 5.9 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

5.0 INTRODUCTION

What is journalism, exactly? Journalism is the process of gathering, organising, and distributing news. It is completed along with related commentary and feature materials through print and electronic media, including newspapers, books, blogs, webcasts, podcasts, magazines, social networking and social media sites, radio, movies, and television. The words "journalist," "journal," and "journalism" are all derivations of the French word "journal," which is derived from the Latin word "diurnalis," or "daily." Perhaps the world's first newspaper was the Acta Diurna, a handwritten message posted daily in the Forum, ancient Rome's main public plaza. Pamphlets, tracts, reviews, magazines, gazettes, newsbooks, corantos, news sheets, and letters later in history became known as "newspapers." Those who wrote for them were initially referred to as "news writers," "essayists," or even "mercurists," and then "journalists." The term "journalism" was originally used when newspapers regularly reported current events. However, the 20th century marked the emergence of radio, television, and the Internet as electronic communication reporting current affairs.

"Journalism is the carrying of information from here to there with accuracy, insight and quickness and in such a manner that the truth is served and the rightness of things is made slowly, even if not instantly, more visible," says Eric Hodgins of Time Magazine.

Journalism is defined as "The collection and editing of current interest material for presentation, publication, or transmission" in the third edition of Webster's International Dictionary. The word "journal"—a daily register or diary—is the root of the phrase "journalism."

Looking at the emergence of journalism, the Acta Diurna, a news sheet believed to have originated before 59 BCE and circulated in ancient Rome, is the first known example of a journalistic work. Among the important daily happenings recorded by the Acta Diurna were public addresses. It was published daily and clearly displayed. In Tang Dynasty China, a bao, or "report," was a court circular sent to government authorities. This gazette was published under many names and in various formats up until the 1911 Qing dynasty's collapse. Around 1609, the first regularly published newspapers appeared in Antwerp and places in Germany. The Weekly News, the earliest English newspaper, debuted in 1622. One of the first daily newspapers, the Daily Courant, debuted in 1702.

Since then, journalism has advanced significantly. Today, anyone who makes a significant contribution to the gathering, selection, and processing of news and current affairs for the press, radio, film, television, cable, the Internet, blogs, social media, podcasts, mobile phones and various personal digital assistants (PDAs), streaming media, and news apps is considered a journalist. Journalism is the profession to which they belong. Thus, journalists include producers, directors, managing editors, camera crews, audio and video editors, news readers, correspondents, assistant editors, reporters, sub-editors, proofreaders, cartoonists, photographers (sometimes known as "photojournalists"), online journalists, and news bloggers. Part-time journalists are referred to as "stringers," whilst freelance journalists are individuals who occasionally contribute to newspapers.

According to the Working Journalists' Act of 1955, a "working journalist" is a person whose primary occupation is journalism, and they are employed as such, either full- or part-time, in or related to one or more newspaper establishments. This definition includes editors, leader writers, news editors, sub-editors, feature writers, copy-testers, reporters, correspondents, cartoonists, news photographers, and proofreaders. Still, it excludes any such individuals who: a) are employed primarily in managerial or b) administrative capacities.

A rise in professionalism characterised the 20th century in journalism. Four key elements contributed to this trend: the expanding organisation of working journalists, journalism-specific education, the expansion of the literature on the development, issues, and methods of mass communication, and the growing sense of social responsibility among journalists.

5.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- understand the basic tenets of journalistic practices;
- describe different types of journalism; and
- explain the various genres of the journalistic profession.

5.2 NATURE OF JOURNALISM

Journalism is the timely reporting of happenings at the local, regional, national, and worldwide levels. Reporting requires compiling material from sources such as interviews and research into a fair and balanced article that will be published or broadcast on radio or television.

Even though these aspects of journalism can occasionally play a part, obtaining data, analysing media, writing opinions, and offering analysis are only some of what journalism entails. Journalism is a social activity that focuses on disseminating information and viewpoints about society.

Currently, journalism is gradually altering in character. In the beginning, people used to believe the news in the newspaper more.

The news in the newspaper also acted as a sort of seal at the same time. However, the news reported in newspapers began to pique people's interest over time.

As a result, TV news started following newspaper news. After viewing TV news, people started to see events for themselves. TV news stations, as a result, gained popularity. On TV, viewers started to express a desire to watch the occurrence on tape. The importance of television news increased at the same time. The gestures would be acceptable if there were a scam or if a politician did this.

People started to link TV news channels with news that was printed in newspapers as a result. There are now hundreds of new TV stations available. There have been many new TV channel openings due to the market's interest in TV channels. It is a common misconception that news started to be broadcast on television stations.

In recent years, journalism has seen yet another change. No one could watch the events 24 hours a day on television. Social media started to take off after that. Social media became successful when users started disseminating news from many regions in their own distinctive ways.

Because of this, the definition of journalism and how one approaches it rely on how one views and values the news. According to this definition, news is a description of an event, not a component of the event itself. Thus, "news" refers to the written, aural, or visual construction of an event, occurrence, or individual. Nothing about the incident itself qualifies as news; it is not the news. The written account of the incident or its audio or video presentation is what is considered "news." Additionally, for a presentation, "representation,"

or "construction" of an event to qualify as "news," it must follow a specific format and be chosen in accordance with a specific professional value system.

5.3 OWNERSHIP PATTERN OF MEDIA

The ownership structure of the media in our nation significantly impacts the content it produces. Some ownership patterns are:

- **Individual Ownership Pattern:** In this type of ownership, a single individual is the owner of the media house. The individual is the one responsible for all the decision-making of the business. This kind of media ownership is mostly seen in small media businesses. For example, the Daily English newspaper The News Today is published in Chennai.
- **Corporation Ownership Pattern:** In this type of ownership, a group of people governed by the law have separate rights and obligations from one another and a continuous existence apart from that of its members. A company is, for example, the BBC group. They can be found on various websites, television, and radio stations. Expanding operations with more money is simple, and changing control is flexible. However, there are collaboration taxes.
- **Group/ Chain Ownership:** In this type of ownership, a single entity manages two or more of the same mediums. They are constituted using a chain of command rather than a common holding. Thirteen issues of Hindustan are published in Hindu by HT Media. Even though Aaj Tak and Headlines Today are separate networks, they are both owned by the India Today company. The ability to centrally manage financial, administrative, and human resources is a benefit of this type of collaboration. Due to the greatest possible resource use, manufacturing costs are reduced; better training, a better working environment, and additional facilities are supplied as a result. However, because management is fragmented, management stability is never assured.
- **Horizontal and vertical integration:** The term "horizontal integration" describes a media company's presence across several media segments (print, TV, FM radio). A magazine, Books, radio, newspapers, television, etc., can be owned by a single media company. Media companies almost always have horizontal integration. It increases revenue and increases public perception and visibility of the business.
- A media business with vertical integration has a complete monopoly in creating the materials used to create media goods. For instance, film studios produce and release films for their own audiences. Chains of cinemas Vertical integration describes this situation. These businesses could be studios, film stock companies, or even a network of movie theatres where the Movies are shown.
- **Cross-media ownership:** Cross-media ownership refers to a company's ownership of multiple media companies, such as a newspaper, magazine, and television station. The advantages of it include reduced costs, wider

reach, etc. The major disadvantage is that it becomes extremely persuasive, and communication is unidirectional and tends to be biased. India's Times Group, Network 18 Group, and other organisations are examples of cross-media ownership.

- **Conglomerate:** In this type of ownership, under the same corporate structure, two or more businesses are clubbed together and are operating in different industries. A media conglomerate is a multi-industry organisation that owns different businesses in different media, including television, radio, the Internet, and other platforms. For example, MTV, Comedy Central, VH1, and other media outlets are owned by Viacom.

5.4 JOURNALISTIC ETHICS

A common set of guidelines known as journalistic ethics serves as a guide for reporters. They outline the objectives and duties that writers, editors, and other field professionals should follow to conduct their work morally.

Journalism ethics have evolved over time. Most news organisations have established codes of ethics, similar to professional membership organisations. A professional journalist or news organisation will lose credibility if they transgress certain ethical standards.

Around 400 codes are relevant to the journalism industry globally. The majority of codes share certain characteristics, such as the values of independence, objectivity, impartiality, fairness, respect for others, and public accountability, all of which apply to the gathering, editing, and public dissemination of newsworthy information, even though the specifics of each code may differ. They may come from various cultural traditions.

The goal of journalism's codes of ethics is to protect the integrity of reported material by defining appropriate conduct and providing guidance on avoiding circumstances that can threaten or appear to threaten veracity. Conflicts of interest are among the situations to prevent. The recommendations support journalists in recognising and resolving moral problems. When such situations cannot be avoided, they should be stated so that those who will be receiving the information can assess any potential bias in the reporting. The codes of ethics provide a framework for self-monitoring and self-correction for journalists. Following are the basic principles laid down to maintain the balance:

- **Honesty:** Journalists must be truthful. It is unacceptable to report on information that is known to be untrue or to present facts in a way that conveys a false impression;
- **Fairness:** Journalists are required to report the facts objectively and neutrally, including any opposing views or sides to a story that may exist. To distort the truth is undesirable;
- **Relevance:** A journalist should be diligent in gathering and presenting relevant information to provide readers with a thorough knowledge of the story;

- **Accountability:** A journalist needs to be responsible for their job and willing to face the repercussions of their actions.

Creating a comprehensive, rigid code of ethics for journalists is neither sensible nor practical. Society keeps evolving throughout time. Therefore, it is useless to try to enact unbreakable rules or regulations. But we require some guidelines or norms in the form of a "code of ethics" to regulate how journalists behave. According to Justice R.S. Sarkaria, the former chairman of the Press Council of India, a journalistic code of ethics is necessary. The code of ethics, in his opinion, is a set of general moral principles that are meant to guide and assist journalists as they engage in the process of self-evaluation and self-regulation. This led to the creation of other codes. 1968, the All-India Newspaper Editors' Conference established a code of ethics (AINEC). Other codes, such as the International Code (1991) and the Parliamentary Code (1976), were also recommended as guidelines for the media. Despite its resistance to strict standards, the Press Council has occasionally produced guidelines.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Define journalism in your own words.

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2. What is your understanding of the different prevailing media ownership patterns? How has it affected the news that is being disseminated?

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3. What is the importance of ethics in journalism?

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4. What are the different types of journalism? Elaborate on three of them.

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5. If you were a journalist, which genre would you like to work on and why?

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5.5 TYPES OF JOURNALISM

5.5.1 Radio Journalism

Today, news and news-based programmes have an impact on almost every facet of daily life. Radio gives real-time news, which is essential to society and is one of the quickest and easiest ways of communication. The time when you had to sit through a newsreader reading off a list of news items from the text of a news bulletin is long gone. Sound bites and actuality inserts may liven up and make a newscast more entertaining to listen to. Along with the newsreader, the viewer can hear the voices of other people and the newscaster. Radio programmes can also be delivered via a number of brand-new and emerging channels, including "Direct-to-home (DTH), satellite radio, Internet streaming, web radio, mobile apps, podcasting, etc.

Because of this, a radio journalist needs to be familiar with the most recent methods for news development, production, and dissemination to keep up with industry technological advancements. The collecting of news has grown to be a crucial radio role.

A radio station's main news sources are its journalists, news organisations, and monitoring division. News is not created in the newsroom or radio station. For this to happen, the reporter needs contacts. Additional sources for radio news include press conferences, speeches, interviews, and government press releases. The radio newsroom also subscribes to and receives news items from numerous news outlets. The news organisations that provide these stories, referred to as copies, are both domestic and foreign (such as Reuters, the Associated Press (AP), Agence France-Presse (AFP), Press Trust of India (PTI), United News of India (UNI), Bhasha, and Univarta).

5.5.2 Television Journalism

A sizable portion of the population views television news as a form of mass media. It has a more profound impact because it is an audio-visual medium. Therefore, technology must be used responsibly for the welfare of the general public—to inform, educate, and raise public consciousness, as well as to eradicate all the ills that are rampant because of ignorance.

Television literally means "seeing at a distance." It is a compound term made up of the Latin word vision, which means sight, and the Greek prefix tele-, which means far away. According to Alfred Dinsdale (2000), television's short definition is "vision through telegraphy."

There was a period when commotion and disruption were produced and

reported on as news. Stories with a lot of violence, brutality, and superstition were portrayed sensationally since they attracted many viewers and raised the TRP rating. Therefore, content creators must exercise considerable self-control and constraint in order to fulfil their obligations. Therefore, TV news outlets are responsible for monitoring governance, which they typically do. TV plays a far larger role in a nation like India, where corruption is pervasive and permeates every aspect of our culture. TV shows are frequently used to expose corruption, such as in "sting operations" that use spy cameras to reveal corrupt instances.

5.5.3 Online Journalism

The phrase "online journalism" refers to written and disseminated content. Alternatively, this is a type of online journalism. The difference between "citizen journalism" and online journalism must be made. Material published by online journalism is on par with that available in print and broadcast media (such as newspapers, magazines, radio and television). It follows the same standards of conduct as traditional journalism. In contrast to citizen journalism, it is unrestricted by any codes of conduct that would be considered professional or ethical. Digital media is a vehicle for technology and serves as its medium.

Hypertextuality, multimodality, interaction, and immediacy are traits of Internet journalism. Real-time and interactive reporting can be found online. Multimedia components can be used in online journalism, such as text and images (found in newspapers and books), audio, video, motion graphics, 3D, etc. Combining several media aspects for a news article to increase interactivity is one of multimedia journalism's greatest prospects. The main tool for this interactivity on the web is hyperlinks. Several media options are supplied via hyperlinks to add additional in-depth analysis to a news package. Through interactivity, individuals have the opportunity to provide comments on and enhance the pre-existing content.

5.5.4 Photojournalism

The dissemination of news using images is referred to as photojournalism. As well as online news sources and micro-blogging websites, these photos frequently appear in print publications, including newspapers and magazines. A picture can quickly improve the story that a news item conveys to its viewers and is said to be worth 1,000 words.

A photojournalist is a reporter, similar to a writer, but they frequently face substantial challenges, such as direct physical risk, poor weather, etc. They also frequently need to make quick choices and carry photographic equipment.

The same moral standards for objectivity are used in photojournalism as in other journalism forms. It is the moral duty of photojournalists to choose which photographs to shoot, stage, and release to the public.

5.5.5 Print Journalism

Investigating and reporting on events for a large audience in newspapers,

magazines, or other printed media is known as print journalism. Even today, journalism is one of the fields with the highest regard nationwide. Every year, more than 5,000 newspapers register with RNI, and over 2.6 million sheets of newsprint are used. Numerous openings have resulted from this exponential rise in India's print journalism industry. The impact of print journalism is enormous; every day, millions of people read news stories that numerous local and national outlets publish throughout the day.

The different types of print journalism are newspaper journalism, magazine journalism, etc.

5.6 GENRES OF JOURNALISM

5.6.1 Sports Journalism

Covering news and happenings in both amateur and professional sports is the main focus of sports journalism. All media, including print, broadcast television, and the Internet, employ sports writers.

In the early 1800s, sports journalism was first targeted at the social elite. It became a significant part of the news business as it grew, with newspapers having dedicated sports departments. Sports are becoming more popular among middle-class and lower-class people, which has led to an increase in the number of magazines with sports-related content. Outlets like Sports Illustrated and ESPN were founded because of the public's interest in sports.

Verifying information provided to you and uncovering the truth behind rumours about athletes, sports commentators, teams, and players are the duties of sports journalists. The same professional and ethical standards must be upheld at all times, and you must be careful to avoid displaying prejudice against any club or player.

5.6.2 Science Journalism

Modern science journalism is attributed as being inspired by the Bengal, India-based educational monthly Digdarshan. Digdarshan published essays on various scientific subjects, such as flora, steamships, etc. English, Hindi, and Bengali were the available languages.

Science journalism became a career only in the second part of the 20th century. Science journalism is a specialised style of journalism that primarily covers topics related to science, medicine, and technology. Print, audio-visual, and online media are often the primary sources that people use to learn about these subjects; as a result, science journalism plays a significant role in society.

A science journalist's mission is to convey highly specialised, accurate, often jargon-filled, and technically complex material provided by scientists in a manner that non-scientists can appreciate. One strategy science journalism might use is to steer clear of the information deficit model of communication, which assumes a top-down, one-way information exchange and limits an open dialogue between knowledge holders and the general audience.

5.6.3 Civic Journalism

Public journalism, as defined by Rosen, is a way of approaching the business of the profession that encourages journalists to:

- address people as citizens, potential participants in public affairs, rather than victims or spectators;
- assist the political community in acting on, rather than simply learning about, its problems;
- improve the climate of public debate rather than simply watching it deteriorate;
- help make public life go well so that it earns its claim on our attention;
- be open about its civic values, political preferences, and role as a public actor.

To assist citizens in recognising potential areas of consensus and offering information on how they can participate in shaping solutions if they wish to do so, civic journalism strives to expand the diversity of perspectives in stories, uncover the underlying values behind individuals' viewpoints, and facilitate the identification of potential shared interests.

Civic journalism involves the average person using journalism to solve problems. It includes people who ordinarily wouldn't participate in governmental solutions and others who are ordinarily left out of the process.

5.6.4 Business Journalism

The area of journalism known as "business journalism" monitors, documents, dissects, and evaluates social and economic changes. Personal finances, business at the neighbourhood market and malls, the success of well-known and lesser-known corporations, and more might all be included. Business-related persons, locations, and topics are covered in news and feature stories in this genre of journalism. The majority of news programmes on radio, television, newspapers, and magazines feature a business portion. However, newspapers, radio stations, and television networks that are solely committed to covering business and finance journalism can be found.

Some of the top business newspapers are Business Standard, The Economic Times, Financial Chronicle, Financial Express, The Hindu Business Line, and Mint.

5.6.5 Entertainment Journalism

Entertainment journalism refers to any journalism that focuses on popular culture, the entertainment sector, and its products. Like fashion journalism, entertainment journalism covers industry news while attempting to appeal to people outside of the industry. Examples of common types include lifestyle, television and cinema, theatre, music, video games, and celebrity coverage.

Similar to other industries, the entertainment sector is meant to have standardised procedures and ethical standards to facilitate career advancement. Any profession's adherence to and observance of ethics are

steps to ensure that the activities and procedures of the specific industry are governed for the participants' effectiveness in regard to the fair treatment of clients.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What are the key differences between investigative journalism, feature journalism, and sports journalism, and how do they serve distinct purposes in media reporting?

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2. How do entertainment journalism, political journalism, and science journalism contribute uniquely to informing and engaging audiences?

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3. Compare and contrast opinion journalism, photojournalism, and business journalism, and discuss their roles in shaping public discourse.

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5.7 LET US SUM UP

Definitions of journalism vary from individual to individual and reflect varied concerns and objectives. **'JOURNALISM HAS COME TO BE THOUGHT OF AS A PROFESSION, AN INDUSTRY, A PHENOMENON, AND A CULTURE.'** Because journalists, journalism educators, and academics follow distinct trajectories when thinking critically about the field, attempts to define journalism often take various forms. The populations from which people come, the kind of news work being referenced, the medium and technology, and the pertinent historical era and geographic setting are all considered when naming, labelling, evaluating, and critically analysing journalism and journalistic practice. For instance, renowned broadcast journalist Daniel Schorr stated that reporting was "a frame of mind" for him rather than just a means of support.

With the evolving technology, journalism has evolved, keeping pace with the latest technology. From print journalism to online journalism, radio journalism to podcast news, the ways and methods have evolved, keeping the

heart of it intact. Providing fair, unbiased and factual news has always remained at the core of journalists. Hence, a clear understanding of the different ownership types, such as chain ownership, conglomerate, etc., helps us understand the current journalistic practice trends. The different genres of journalism are widening with time. New genres are coming up that cater to the requirements of the new generation audience.

5.8 FURTHER READINGS

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5.9 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. Journalism is the art of gathering, analysing, and presenting information to inform and engage the public about current events, issues, and stories that shape society.
2. Prevailing media ownership patterns include concentrated, diversified, and state-controlled ownership. Concentrated ownership limits viewpoints, while diversified ownership fosters diverse content. State control can lead to bias and censorship, influencing the news disseminated.
3. Ethics in journalism are vital to maintaining credibility, impartiality, and trust with the audience. Adhering to principles like accuracy, fairness, and transparency ensures responsible reporting and upholds the media's role as a watchdog.
4. Types of journalism include investigative, feature, opinion, sports, and more. Investigative journalism uncovers hidden truths, feature stories focus on human interest, and opinion pieces offer subjective viewpoints.
5. A journalist would choose investigative journalism because it allows her/him to delve deep into issues, shed light on corruption, and empower the public with information that can drive positive change.

Check Your Progress 2

1. Investigative journalism uncovers hidden truths and exposes corruption, feature journalism focuses on human interest stories, and sports journalism covers sports events and athletes' achievements.
2. Entertainment journalism covers celebrities and pop culture, political journalism informs on politics and governance, while science journalism communicates scientific developments and discoveries to the public.
3. Opinion journalism provides subjective viewpoints, photojournalism uses images to convey news, and business journalism covers economic trends and corporate affairs, influencing public perceptions and decision-making.

UNIT 6 TECHNOLOGY, SOCIETY AND THE FOURTH ESTATE

Structure

- 6.0 Introduction
- 6.1 Learning Outcomes
- 6.2 Society and Technology: An Overview
- 6.3 Fourth Estate: Concept, Origin and Significance
- 6.4 Socio-Technical Interface and the Fourth Estate
 - 6.4.1 Socio-Technical Systems Model
- 6.5 Growth and Development of Fourth Estate: Carving its Niche
 - 6.5.1 Print Media (Newspaper)
 - 6.5.2 Broadcast Media
 - 6.5.3 New Media
- 6.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 6.7 Keywords
- 6.8 Further Readings
- 6.9 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

6.0 INTRODUCTION

Dear Learners! The society we live in has progressed by leaps and bounds. This progress can be safely attributed to technological advancements made by humans, off and on. The technological developments help to make the world a better place to live in. On the other hand, the Fourth Estate, commonly referred to as the press, functions as a mirror of society. It helps to communicate, educate, inform, entertain, influence and persuade its audience for the desired effects and actions. A blended combination of technology and the Fourth Estate works wonders for society, provided it is used in the right spirit.

6.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After completion of the Unit, you will be able to:

- understand various technological advancements that have taken place in society and how the Fourth Estate has played its part in highlighting these advancements and identifying gaps in the process;
- explore and examine different technological developments that have taken place in a society and have made human life easy and prosperous and the way the Fourth Estate has played its role in reflecting the same through its coverage;
- identify various societal needs and associated technological growth and the way the Fourth Estate has played its part in promoting socio-technical interface for the overall public good; and

- develop a critical understanding of the role of the Fourth Estate in society and its use in the dispersal of technological adoption in society.

6.2 SOCIETY AND TECHNOLOGY: AN OVERVIEW

As we all know, technology shapes our society. It has been doing so right from the beginning of human society. Remember when early man discovered fire, invented the wheel and learned to grow food? This started the human quest for knowledge and innovations and led him/her to progress and prosperity. As time passed, fresh challenges emerged, and human beings responded with new innovations. Furthermore, the same continues...

Both societal needs/challenges and technological advancements go hand-in-hand, providing impetus to the other. Modern means and modes of transportation, mechanised farming practices, development of health and sports facilities, the emergence of the printing press, other communication gadgets, satellite, mobile, telecommunication and now 5G, Artificial Intelligence, Virtual Reality, Augmented Reality, Drone technology and so on. The list is exhaustive... Technology has influenced each and every aspect of human society and has tried to cater to their diverse needs and requirements.

Human curiosity 'to explore and to know more' keeps them literally on their toes and in pursuit of new knowledge and novel innovations. Thus paving the way for technology to be explored and utilised for the overall benefit of society. Society, on the other hand, can be described as a web of complex and interrelated systems and structures that perform specific functions and support each other with a purpose to grow and sustain.

Society, as we know, is faced with innumerable challenges and threats apart from huge possibilities to prosper. This is where the role of '*Fourth Estate*', commonly referred to as 'press', comes in. It acts as a mirror to society, reflecting what is happening where and communicating human issues and concerns in terms of what needs to be done where, when and how. So, societal needs are the driving force for technology to thrive and drive, and the Fourth Estate acts as a mediator between society and technology. It gives voice to their needs and expressions of their achievements/developments and acts as a facilitator to bridge cracks and gaps.

Now, let us briefly examine what 'technology' and 'society' refers to:

Derived from the Greek words *techne* and *logos*, technology has been variously defined as:

According to Kumar, Kumar and Persaud (1999), technology comprises two primary components: A physical component that comprises items such as products, tooling, equipment, blueprints, techniques and processes and an informational component which consists of know-how in management, marketing, production, quality control, reliability, skilled labour and functional areas.

Merriam-Webster defines technology as applying knowledge to the practical aims of human life or changing and manipulating the human environment. It includes using materials, tools, techniques and power sources to make life easier or more pleasant and work more productive. While science concerns how and why things happen, technology focuses on making things happen.

MacKenzie and Wajcman (1985) define technology as the integration of physical objects or artefacts, the process of making the objects and the meaning associated with the physical objects.

Woolgar (1987) adds that these elements are not distinctive and separable factors but form a 'seamless web' that constitutes technology.

Burkin (1999) further explained that technology is the application of scientific and other knowledge to practical tasks by ordered systems that involve people, organisations, living things and machines. Any systematised practical knowledge based on experimentation and/or scientific theory enhances society's capacity to produce goods and services and is embodied in productive skills, organisation, or machinery.

Derived from the Latin word *socius*, society means association or togetherness. In common parlance, it refers to a group of people living together within any given place or region having shared values, traditions and culture.

The concept of society has been variously defined as:

While August Comte, the father of sociology, explained society as a social organism possessing a harmony of structure and function, Emile Durkheim, the founding father of modern sociology, viewed society as a reality in its own right. Merton (1968) observed society as a complex system of interrelated parts – all of which perform specific activities designed to maintain society's even and steady functioning.

According to Talcott Parsons, society is a total complex of human relationships as they grow out of the action in terms of means-end relationships, intrinsic or symbolic. For Morris Ginsberg, society is a collection of individuals united by certain relations or modes of behaviour which mark them off from others who do not enter into these relations or who differ from them in behaviour.

For Maclver and Page, society is a system of usages and procedures, authority and mutual aid, many groupings and divisions, and human behaviour and liberties controls.

As per George Simmel, society is an element of sociability or companionship that defines its true essence.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. A group of people living together in a common territory with shared values, tradition and culture is
2. Emile Durkheim regarded society as
3. Morris Ginsberg defines society as
4. Kumar, Kumar and Persaud (1999) state that technology comprises two primary components:

6.3 FOURTH ESTATE: CONCEPT, ORIGIN AND SIGNIFICANCE

As already discussed, *the Fourth Estate*, commonly called the press, occupies a significant societal position. It reflects a society's happenings, frames public opinion, and influences decision-making at various levels. Generally speaking, the significance of the press in any democratic set-up is to keep its citizenry informed and updated while acting as a bridge between the government and the governed.

Often, the term *Fourth Estate* signifies the ability of media to influence the system. It presents the press, media and journalists playing a crucial part in society, as Sermaxhai (2020) put forth. Several scholars have referred to the media as the Fourth Estate. With the rise of the press and its power to reach every nook and corner of the state, it can also be considered the fourth pillar of democracy (Ranjan and Kashyap (2014). The term (*Fourth Estate*) refers to the press and news media in its explicit and implicit ability to frame the issues of the day, maintains Cooke (2019).

The term *Fourth Estate* is attributed to the eighteenth-century English political philosopher and commentator Edmund Burke, who used it in a parliamentary debate in 1787. In his book, *On Heroes and Hero Worship*, the nineteenth-century British historian Thomas Carlyle stated, "Burke said there were three Estates in Parliament; but, in the Reporters' Gallery yonder, there sat a Fourth Estate more important far than they all."

George Verghese, in 1981, stressed that the primary role of the press in a society is to keep the public informed and updated. Undoubtedly, the influence of media in society has been tremendously significant. Generating awareness, building opinions, disseminating information, rendering government accountable, ensuring a transparent system, and influencing socio-political and behavioural change are some of its note-worthy contributions. Fourth Estate usually refers to the watchdog role of the press, wherein it constantly reflects, informs, inspires, and shapes our society. It even acts as a tool of persuasion, motivation, and a change-maker.

Let us explain this by taking an example of drug abuse in society. We all know that drug addiction is one of the serious challenges confronting society. The press has been covering this almost every time in the form of reportage, editorials, public service advertisements, and press releases issued by the government or non-government organisations to keep its audience informed and persuade them to act towards its eradication. The objective of such reportage is also to reflect on how the menace (drug abuse) is eating into the

very vitals of our society. The press coverage even recommends certain measures that could be taken to curb this social evil plaguing society, thus acting as a change-maker as well.

Similarly, the *Fourth Estate* plays a critical role in properly functioning participatory democracy. It informs, educates, criticises, and stimulates debate on various issues and topics that strengthen governance and ensure transparency and accountability in a democratic set-up. For example, discussions revolving around the importance of adult franchises and how the same plays its part in the growth of societies, strengthening democracies, making the political spectrum vibrant, interactive, and answerable and thus, marching ahead progressively.

Again, the Fourth Estate helps disseminate scientific knowledge and social and moral values. It acts as a bridge between our scientific labs, scientific knowledge, scientists, and the common person on the street. It breaks down complex and technical information into lucid language so that even a person with less literacy component can comprehend it. For example, acts as a facilitator and communicator between farmers, agriculture scientists, and various government departments. It also helps circulate messages and information from the Meteorological department to the common person, from weather advisories to flood threats. This information helps people plan their daily routine work and take necessary precautions to avoid or minimise losses. Still more needs to be done in this aspect. These are all examples where technology and the Fourth Estate supplement each other for the overall societal good.

The contribution of the *Fourth Estate* in nation-building has always been indispensable. This can be explained with the help of an example. Different types of investments in crucial sectors like health, business, banking, and agricultural sectors are of paramount importance. Developing an entrepreneurial mindset, especially among youth, is also imperative for societies/communities to be self-reliant and sustainable. The press has and can chip in and play its part in opinion-building, disseminating information and motivating youth to act. It can also help to plug the loopholes and deficiencies, if any. Interaction and exchange programmes with experts, sponsors, investors, and entrepreneurs can be conducted so that the energies of the budding and skilled workforce can be utilised in the right perspective. Media can act as a role of information-disseminator, facilitator, and guide. Undoubtedly, the role and responsibility of the Fourth Estate have been tremendous and much needed than ever before.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY (FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION) 1:

Prepare a list of the importance of *the Fourth Estate* in society. Divide students into different groups and assign them topics from the list. Conduct Focus Group Discussion (FGD) on the assigned topics emphasising relevant examples at local, national, and international levels.

A two-page report based on FGD is to be prepared by each group, and the same is to be submitted and evaluated by their Academic Facilitators.

6.4 SOCIO-TECHNICAL INTERFACE AND THE FOURTH ESTATE

Dear Learners, now you must have realised that we live in a society where life without technology is unimaginable. Both technology and society facilitate each other, which are woven inseparably. Technology has been used in every sphere of life, from household chores to professional work to exploring space. Technology has brought remarkable changes in the way of living, learning, communication, and so on. At the same time, it poses several threats/risks to human life. Reduced physical activities adversely affect human health; more time spent on electronic gadgets, especially computers/laptops/mobile phones, minimised social interactions. New challenges, such as cybercrimes and cyberbullying, have emerged.

Already, human societies are faced with innumerable threats/challenges in terms of pollution, abrupt changes in weather and rainfall patterns that impact our water sources and crop production (our lifelines), health hazards and life-threatening diseases apart from the need to produce more food, need to reduce travel time, making travel comfortable and exploring new travel destinations and exploring space. To meet these requirements and to overcome these challenges, technology has always been at their disposal. With every new challenge/threat to human society, technology has been developed, evolved and utilised for human good. It can be rightly said that technology has intervened in all spheres of human life and all fields of human activities. Judicious use of technology is the best way to move forward.

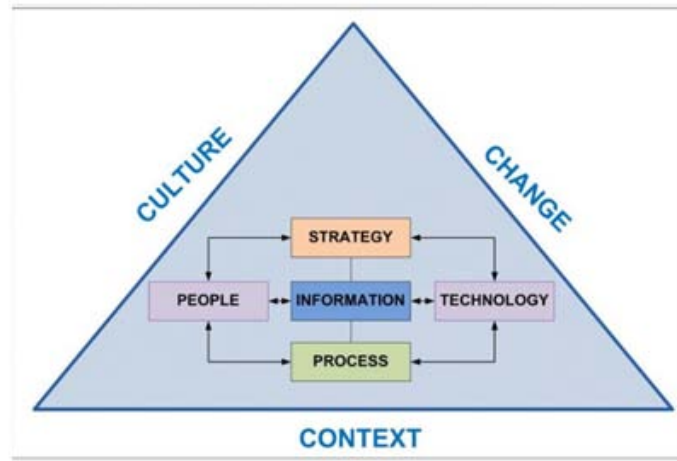
As technology and human society supplement each other, the socio-technical interface gets prominence. An interactive process between human beings and their technical inventions analysed broadly can be termed a socio-technical interface (Athique, 2013).

Socio-technical systems bring human communities and technology together to resolve various societal problems. Hutchins (2021) observed that humanising technology requires recognising the complex web of factors that influence people, their devices and how they interface with each other. He further stated that it is an ongoing process that never truly ends - just as humans grow, change and evolve, so should our technology and engagement with it.

Developing a broader understanding of the inherent relationship between society and technology is imperative in this context.

6.4.1 Socio-Technical Systems Model

To understand the relationship between society (people) and technology, let us explain the Socio-Technical Systems Model put forth by Prof. Sharon Cox, Birmingham City University, in 2018, as shown in the *Figure* below.



Socio-Technical Systems Model (Cox, 2018)

Socio

Society (people) will use technology only if it is relevant and useful. As such, the people component of the socio-technical model acknowledges its human element, whether they use or reject it. The more people-friendly technology is, the more it is used. Knowledge, motivation, priorities, values and beliefs are key factors influencing human engagement with technology. Some of these elements are intrinsic, whereas others are derived from the culture and context of the situation.

Technology

Being a brainchild of humans, it is a result of the application of knowledge. It is a creation carved from the socio component that establishes the first relationship between socio and technical aspects. Here, the focus is mostly on technical attributes, including material, speed, design, and functionality.

Socio-Technical: Requirement Driven

We all know that knowledge is used to design technology with specific functionality. To understand the need for functionality, first, we need to understand the task for which the technology is expected to be used. The task that is to be done will be determined by how people are organised, how communication is structured, and the duties assigned. The four elements – People, technology, task, and structure form Leavitt's Diamond, establishing the inter-relationship between the elements. Any change in one element will affect the other elements in the model.

Socio-Technical: Interaction Driven

Here, the structures of the task will affect how people will use the technology. This has led to work in human-computer interaction that again emphasises the interface between people and technology. It seeks to analyse the relationship between cognitive processes (socio-) and physical technology features (---technical).

Socio-Technical: Information Driven

People need information to make decisions and take action. Any strategy, at the individual or organisation level, provides the rationale for doing the same.

Processes and technology facilitate access to information that tries to meet people's requirements and strategies in any situation. The information is surrounded within certain parameters of culture and context.

Consequently, the socio-technical systems model reflects the following:

- Who is involved in the situation, the people in the situation and the culture of the individual and organisation
- What information is required and the perceptions held by people
- Why information is required, the strategy provides rationale for information
- How an individual and technology interact through processes
- When and where the interaction is required, the context and any potential change being undertaken.

The inter-relationships between the components of the socio-technical systems model are complex. Attempts to deconstruct the relationships to understand individual elements can fail to capture the complexity of the relationship. The complexities emerge from the dynamic interaction between tangible and intangible elements that form a socio-technical context and the conflicting perceptions within it. More emphasis should be placed on core values that address beliefs, perceptions and interpretations of information (Cox, 2018).

Interestingly, one of the best-known theoretical accounts of modern media associated with a technologically determined viewpoint is the body of work produced during the 1960s by Canadian scholar Marshall McLuhan. McLuhan's central thesis was outlined in his book *Understanding Media: The Extensions of Man* (1964). McLuhan believed we live amid a turbulent, unseen revolution, where human technologies become extensions of the human organism and the central nervous system.

Amodu, Usaini and Ige (2014) argued that the *Fourth Estate*, or the public sphere guardians, performs conventional functions that aim to build an ideal free and healthy society to foster a true democracy. Some of these functions are listed below:

Information: Provides accurate and significant information on what is happening within and outside our societies. The information is related to diverse areas, including politics, socio-economic issues, development concerns, etc. The information gathered and received helps the public to make informed decisions and better choices.

Entertainment: Refers to the ability of media to help relax people using different genres of programmes such as comedy, drama, soap operas, films, reality shows and so on.

Education: As the *Fourth Estate*, the media promotes intellectual growth among its citizens by offering them educational and historical importance coverage. It also helps in sensitisation and awareness generation among its audiences.

Debates and Discussions: This allows audiences to express their views and opinions freely and fairly.

Socialisation and Cultural Promotion: Considered a powerful agent of socialisation, it helps in promoting the cultural heritage of different areas/regions

Motivation: At times, information is also released to motivate, influence, persuade or inspire the public towards a particular set agenda with the purpose of gathering maximum support, loyalty or push.

The most impressive part of the Fourth Estate is that it tries to bring diverse but verified information to your doorsteps while exploring and exposing various aspects of any situation or event that brings out inequalities and discrimination. At times, it even promotes myths and stereotypes and helps maintain checks and balances within a society.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. Discuss some major functions of the Fourth Estate.

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2. Specify some of the key factors that influence human engagement with technology.

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6.5 GROWTH AND DEVELOPMENT OF FOURTH ESTATE: CARVING ITS NICHE

From the discoveries made in the Stone Age to the current internet-driven and Artificial Intelligence-based New Age tools and techniques, technology tries to address the needs and problems of everyday life. It has revolutionised the lives of millions. The computers we work on, the car we drive, the gas heaters, geysers and refrigerators we use in our homes, the hot and cold Air Conditioners we use in our routine work activities and now the solar energy-based appliances that we have recently started using in our day-to-day dealings - all are attributes of the technology.

Coming to the Fourth Estate it has drastically revolutionised with the discovery of the printing press, if not paper. Today, it has come a long way.... Technology has shaped everything from the first newspaper in Rome around 59 BC, *Acta Diurna*, to current online multimedia news platforms. As

in any other sector, technology-facilitated growth in the Fourth Estate and played its immense role in helping to highlight issues and concerns facing human societies, shaping public opinion, addressing human miseries and acting as a bridge between the ruled and the ruler. It can be said that without technology, the Fourth Estate would not exist, grow and survive.

Sapru (2020) emphasised that the history of journalism and publishing is characterised by a close interplay of technical innovation and social change, each promoting the other. Journalism and publishing depend on several major inventions, including writing, paper, printing, investigative and well-researched writings, apart from the spread of literacy in urban and rural areas of the country.

Technology has revolutionised everything from early print to modern publications, from radio to television/film to new media and social media.

6.5.1 Print Media (Newspaper)

The invention of the printing press by Johannes Gutenberg (around 1440-50), together with new transportation technologies, started a new era in human civilisation. It made the production of print (written) material easier, cheaper and in bulk, which helped to reach out to a wider audience. More readers could be reached, and information spread on a large scale. Print media became a popular source of information. By the first half of the 17th century, newspapers emerged as frequent publications. In the latter half of the 17th century, local issues became predominantly significant as news content in these publications. The telegraph's invention in the mid-1800s allowed information to be transmitted quickly, facilitating more timely and relevant reportage. This helped to raise the issues and concerns of human life vehemently.

Technological advancements in print media facilitated the *Fourth Estate* to highlight societal issues and concerns on a broader canvas with more reach and broader impact. As time passed, with more technological modifications, the print media changed its track to stay relevant with technological innovations. They continued discharging their professional duties with zeal and enthusiasm. For example, advancements in newspaper printing and the use of colour printing not only changed the outlook of a newspaper but gave a prominent presentation of its news and other content that helped to grab the attention of readers and advertisers further. Today, almost every newspaper has its own website that keeps updating content with every passing event. During pre-internet times, there was hardly any such concept. This provides an idea about the impact of technology on the presentation and distribution of newspaper content.

6.5.2 Broadcast Media

With the invention of Radio and Television, audiences could enjoy different genres of programmes while enjoying the cosy comforts of their homes. Infotainment is available just at the click of a button. Audio and audio-visual appeal combined with an element of immediacy and proximity keeps the audiences glued to their TV screens and tuned to their radio sets. Technology

placed powerful media in the lap of humanity, wherein infotainment was disseminated with powerful images and visuals, strong audio narratives and mesmerising sound effects.

As technology progressed, programmes were broadcast live (apart from recorded ones). OB (Outside Broadcasting) vans were designed, high-end cameras, lenses and microphones used, and more sophisticated newsrooms catering to both recorded and live programmes/footage or phone-ins were some of the latest technological additions in the broadcast media. This facilitated media professionals in news coverage/footage, news gathering techniques, dissemination of content and so on. Audience engagement was enhanced, and the feedback component improved to make broadcast content more appealing and engaging.

Radio: Almost a century ago, the invention of radio was a welcome delight for all. It has been an efficient means of mass communication since its inception. From its discovery to its current digital form, it has evolved through several stages regarding technology, content, presentation, style and treatment. While on the one hand, technology has been updating it with a new look, potable appearance and compatible features, on the other hand, the structure and formats of programmes targeting its audience have also evolved. From simple talk shows to radio commentaries to radio dramas, radio newsreels, current affairs and specific target audience programmes to phone-in, etc., the radio tries to meet the contemporary needs of their listeners with the aid of related technology in the field.

Radio has been rightly termed as the "medium of masses" as literacy has never been a barrier in this medium, and it has tried to reach each and every nook of our society via its easy affordability, accessibility and reach. From the first regular transmission of radio in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania America, in 1920, it has passed through several stages – Public service broadcasting, commercial potential, sponsored programmes, community radio, AM (Amplitude Modulation), FM (Frequency Modulation), digital radio, podcast and the list goes on...

Television: From the moon landing to live sports coverage to live parliament proceedings to funeral ceremonies of prominent personalities are some memorable events watched by each of us on TV sets while cherishingly sipping a cup of tea or enjoying meals with our family. Thanks to the wondrous innovations and inventions around!

Several key technological developments have taken place in the television industry. During the late 1800s, several developments set the stage for this impressive technology. Television broadcasting began as early as 1928 and became popular in the late 1940s and early 1950s. Its popularity grew mostly because of its audio-visual elements. The colour technology further popularised the medium. The 1950s proved to be the golden age of television, during which it experienced massive growth in popularity. Later, the rise of cable television, the emergence of digital television and now the era of smart television continue to march ahead with its unique and glaring contributions. TV programmes have been continuously focusing on different aspects of public life, be it the Russia-Ukraine crisis, the US pullout from Afghanistan,

Queen Elizabeth's funeral, landing on Mars, and so on, thus bringing new, latest and distinctive happenings across the globe to our cosy corridors.

6.5.3 New Media

Of late, a new technological advancement has emerged on the scene. As mobile internet and smartphone technology surfaced on the world's horizon, New Media, also referred to as multimedia or digital media, came to the fore. A combination of text, images, videos, audio and graphics, New Media presents unique and distinctive characteristics like being direct, instantaneous, engaging and interactive. The three R's define it (New Media) all - Instant, Interactive and Immediate.

While Mitra (2011) defines New Media as a broad term that emerged in the later part of the 20th century to encompass the amalgamation of traditional media such as films, images, music, spoken and written words, with the interactive power of computers also called convergence, computer-enabled consumer devices and most importantly the internet, it holds out a possibility of on-demand access to content anytime, anywhere on any digital device, as well as interactive user feedback, creative participation and community formation around the media content.

Cote (September 2022) observed that New Media is any media - from newspaper articles and blogs to music and podcasts - that are delivered digitally. Any internet-related form of communication can be considered new media, from a website or email to mobile phones and streaming apps. Social media networks, virtual and augmented reality, websites, blogs, music, and television streaming services are a few examples of New Media.

The [New Media Institute](#) defines New Media as a catchall term used to define all that is related to the internet and the interplay between technology, images and sound.

As new technology evolves, develops and is adopted, it continues to modify or transform the society in an apparent or subtle manner. This human-created technology comes to their rescue in case of any contingency or disaster. Say, for example, that humans recently encountered highly contagious COVID-19 that consumed millions of lives and where maintaining physical distance at one point in time became mandatory. Technology helped them to stay virtually connected. Streaming services like Netflix and Spotify and e-shopping showed an upward trend. Physical classrooms paved the way to virtual classrooms; work-for-home became a new norm, and takeaways from restaurants became a common feature. These are the perfect examples to explain how technology came to the rescue of people in times of crises that humans might not have imagined in their wildest dreams. So, technology tries to connect with human necessities. All these technological advancements are the creation of the human mind.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY II: POWERPOINT PRESENTATION

Divide students into groups. Each group should be assigned one media platform (print, radio, television and online). Then, the groups will work

on the historical development of the respective media platform that has been assigned to them.

Prepare a PowerPoint presentation and present it in class. Submit the same for evaluation.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. New Media present certain unique and distinctive characteristics like
.....
2. was the first newspaper published in Rome around 59 BC.
3. The printing press was invented by

6.6 LET US SUM UP

Technological advancements are speeding up. To keep pace with these developments, the *Fourth Estate*, commonly referred to as *the press*, has broadened and accelerated its gear so that it keeps pace with the changing circumstances while upholding its core professional values of accuracy, authenticity and objectivity. Amidst all these technological strings of progressions, the primary job of the Fourth Estate remains the same – to serve the public (society) with facts and objectivity - no matter what the platform is.

Whatever the media – print, broadcast or new (online) - it has always facilitated media professionals in presenting their views and news. Data or content supported by facts and figures, backed by visuals, audio, images or infographics, presented in a dynamic style with a thorough professional appeal helps a media professional tell stories using multiple voices and narratives at the societal level.

In short, societal concerns and technological advancements have been great tools for the *Fourth Estate* – the former provides fodder to think, reflect and raise voice. At the same time, the latter facilitates its reach, appeal and promotion.

6.7 KEYWORDS

OB van: Outside Broadcasting van

Infographic: A visual representation of information and data. An effective tool to present data by combining elements of text, image, video, chart, diagram and so on

AM: (Amplitude Modulation) changes the carrier signals amplitude. It has a stronger signal but is prone to static interference.

FM (Frequency Modulation) moulds itself to the carrier signal to transmit the

information to the user(s)

Community radio: A community space for people to meet and collaborate. Here, local people produce and broadcast their own programmes and participate in operating the station.

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6.9 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. Society
2. A reality in its own right

Morris Ginsberg defines society as a collection of individuals united by certain relations or modes of behaviour that mark them off from others who do not enter into these relations or differ from them in behaviour.

3. A physical component comprises items such as products, tooling, equipment, blueprints, techniques and processes; an informational component consists of know-how in management, marketing, production, quality control, reliability, skilled labour and functional areas.

Check Your Progress 2

1. Some major functions of the Fourth Estate are:

Information: Provides accurate and significant information on what is happening within and outside our societies. The information is related to diverse areas, including politics, socio-economic issues, development concerns, etc. The information gathered and received helps the public to make informed decisions.

Entertainment: Refers to the ability of media to help relax people using different genres of programmes such as comedy, drama, soap operas, films, reality shows and so on.

Education: As the *Fourth Estate*, the media promotes intellectual growth among its citizens by offering them educational and historical importance coverage. It also helps in sensitisation and awareness generation among its audiences.

Debates and Discussions: This allows audiences to express their views and opinions freely and fairly.

Socialisation and Cultural Promotion: Considered a powerful agent of socialisation, it helps in promoting the cultural heritage of different areas/regions.

Motivation: At times, information is also released to motivate, influence, persuade or inspire the public towards a particular set agenda with the purpose of gathering maximum support, loyalty or push.

2. The key factors that influence human engagement with technology are Knowledge, motivation, priorities, values and beliefs

Check Your Progress 3

1. Being direct, instantaneous, engaging and interactive in nature
2. Acta Diurna
3. Johannes Gutenberg



UNIT 7 DEMOCRACY AND THE FOURTH ESTATE

Structure

- 7.0 Introduction
- 7.1 Learning Outcomes
- 7.2 Concept of Democracy
 - 7.2.1 Freedom of Expression
- 7.3 Brief Introduction to the Four Pillars of Democracy
- 7.4 The Fourth Estate
- 7.5 Indian Constitution and Freedom of the Press
 - 7.5.1 Freedom of the Press-Article 19 (1) (a)
- 7.6 Attempts to Curb Freedom of Media
 - 7.6.1 Emergency and the Media
- 7.7 Roles and Responsibility of the Media in a Democratic Establishment
 - 7.7.1 Responsibility of Median in Democratic Country
 - 7.7.2 Media's Role in Indian Democracy
- 7.8 Let Us Sum Up
- 7.9 Further Readings
- 7.10 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

7.0 INTRODUCTION

Democracy is fundamentally structured primarily on the freedom provided to the functioning of its Legislature, Executive, and Judiciary, and the autonomous status provided to the Media. Each of these four pillars must be strong for democracy to be strong, and they work in unison to support one another. A democratic system should act within its domain without losing sight of the larger picture. Media being the fourth estate, in this chapter, we will learn more about the functioning of the fourth estate in a democratic setup, particularly from an Indian perspective.

This Unit covers various aspects related to democracy and media. It begins by defining democracy and introducing the Four Pillars of Democracy. It then delves into the significance of the Fourth Estate and explores the concept of Freedom of the Press. The chapter also examines the relationship between the Constitution and the media, shedding light on the roles and responsibilities of the press. Furthermore, it discusses the media's challenges, including attacks to restrict media freedom. Finally, the chapter concludes with a summary of the key points discussed.

7.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through this Unit, you will be able to:

- understand the basic tenets of freedom of expression;

- discuss the factors that affect the freedom of the press and
- explain the role and responsibilities of media as a fourth pillar of democracy.

7.2 CONCEPT OF DEMOCRACY

India's democracy is regarded as the world's largest democracy. Democracy is described as the government by the people, for the people, and of the people. The primary merit of the democratic system is that it gives freedom of expression to its citizens, among the other Fundamental Rights guaranteed to them. The rule of the country is through its elected representatives.

The word "democracy" has its roots in the ancient Greek word "Kratos," which denotes "power" or "rule," and "Demos," which stands for "the people" or "the many." As a result, democracy is defined as "rule by the people" or "rule by the many." Alternatively, we might state that democracy is fundamentally a form of government in which the populace will have direct or indirect control over the political process through regularly elected representatives. Therefore, in this sense, it can be claimed that in a democratic republic like India, the people hold authority.

The preface of the Indian constitution is based on the concept of sovereignty. India offers a representative parliament where the government is always accountable to the legislature for its decisions and policies. Indian citizens enjoy Political Democracy, Social Democracy, and Economic Democracy. Thus promising social, economic & political justice to all its citizens by promising fundamental rights.

7.2.1 Freedom of Expression

From time immemorial, man has communicated his ideas through various means, such as symbols and signals. Expressions, either in the form of speech or printed, are also now adapted to suit innovative communication technology. The flow of information and ideas is crucial for developing and surviving the democratic society we live in. The Indian government, the Preamble of the Constitution of India, resolves to secure liberty of thought and expression in Part III of the Indian Constitution for the citizens of India. The Right to Freedom of Speech and Expression can be traced in Article 19 (1)(a).

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What is a democratic state?

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2. Write briefly about Art 19 (1) (a).

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7.3 BRIEF INTRODUCTION TO THE FOUR PILLARS OF DEMOCRACY

The balance of democracy is maintained by the three strong pillars of democracy: the Legislature, Executive, Judicial, and Fourth Estate.

The Executive: The Prime Minister's Office and several ministries comprise the Executive, which oversees numerous procedures. The Executive Body comprises the President, Vice-President, Prime Minister, Cabinet Ministers, Secretaries, and Civil Services.

The Legislative: The Legislature is the assembly making laws for political entities like a country or a city. The legislature enacts laws that are called primary legislation.

The Judiciary: A crucial aspect of democracy is the judiciary. The judiciary is responsible for enforcing laws. When a constitution has significant authority, a mediator who can protect citizens' rights should be present. The judiciary protects the rights of citizens guaranteed by the Constitution.

The Fourth Estate: In a democracy, the media is the fourth pillar. The media must play a significant role in maintaining democracy. It serves as a conduit between the government and the populace, educating the latter on the acts, regulations, and inefficiencies of the former. For a democratic country to operate its system to its best, public participation is imperative. It is essential to have a well-informed public, and disseminating information to the right-minded people effectively is the responsibility of the mass media.

7.4 THE FOURTH ESTATE

Media is known as the fourth pillar of democracy. Press and news outlets are called the fourth estate or fourth power because of their stated advocacy roles and their subliminal propensity to define political issues. Media is expected to function like a mirror that reflects the true and harsh realities of the world. However, a closer look at the functioning and content published details us that media functions like a double-edged sword today.

India is recognized as the place for the largest Media market, with over 82,237 newspapers published in English and other regional languages and more than 900 television channels dedicated to broadcasting news 24/7. However, though television channels owned by private agencies have been permitted to telecast news in India, private radio stations have not been permitted to broadcast news. In addition to all the formal sources of providing public news, there are uncontrolled, unrestricted new media

platforms like WhatsApp, Facebook, Twitter, and many more, which pour news from the political, entertainment, and corporate world without any restrictions.

However, it is essential to note that the media's main function is to provide accurate news to its consumers. Among the many challenges, today's media faces the threat of fake news, paid news, or toned news on all platforms, and it goes uncontrolled in New Media platforms.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Explain the significance of coordination between the four pillars of democracy.

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7.5 INDIAN CONSTITUTION AND FREEDOM OF THE PRESS

Speech and expression are essential components of democracy, and both the Indian Constitution and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights guarantee these rights.

Media plays an important role as it influences people in forming opinions and making decisions. Communication Theorists have proved that media content influences its consumers as it not only influences but also sets an agenda. Considering the influence and the reach, the Constitution of India has made certain provisions for laws and regulations that can govern the functions of the media. Some of the laws and regulations are discussed below:

7.5.1 Freedom of the Press – Article 19(1)(a)

The absence of legal and administrative restrictions on disseminating information, viewpoints, knowledge, and ideas is press freedom. From the world's perspective, the origin of the concept of freedom of the Press took place in England. The invention of printing in the later part of the 15th century and the appearance of the newspaper as a powerful medium of expression made persecution for the expression of opinion, even in matters relating to science or philosophy, restored by both the Church and the State.

Newspapers played the role of opposition against monarchical absolutism and fought for Freedom of Expression. The enlightened public supported the cause. In his *Areopagitica* (1644), Milton argues "that free men must have the 'liberty to know, to utter, and to argue freely according to conscience, above all liberties'. The newspapers won their Right to expression. The history of

press freedom in England thus represents a victory of the public over the authority of the licensor. In England, the term "freedom of the press" refers to the freedom to print and publish anything that is not illegal or otherwise unlawful, such as sedition, contempt of Court, obscenity, slander, or blasphemy. The freedom of the Press was first guaranteed by the Constitution of the USA in the year 1776. It is worth recalling the declaration made by Jefferson during his First Amendment towards Freedom of the Press. He said, "Were it left me to decide whether we should have a government without newspapers or newspapers without a government, I should not hesitate to prefer the latter." Pt. Jawahar Lal Nehru, the first Prime Minister of India, echoed similar views: "I would rather have a completely free press, with all the dangers involved in the wrong use of that freedom, than a suppressed or regulated press." Voltaire once said, "I do not agree with a word you say, but I defend to the death your right to say".

Interestingly, contradicting the opinion expressed by Pt. Nehru, Mrs. Indira Gandhi, daughter of Pt. Nehru also adorned India's Prime Minister's position and never strongly believed in absolute freedom of expression. She first expressed her worries about the media in her speech to the International Press Institute Assembly in New Delhi on November 15, 1966. Where she accused it of giving the nation's student turmoil widespread coverage, she said, "How much liberty should the press have in a country like India, which is engaged in fighting a war against poverty, backwardness, superstition, and ignorance." Mrs. Gandhi remarked that the country's main publications and journalists should decide whether to impose any limits on the Press. Nine years later, Mrs. Gandhi declared an emergency, prompting immediate action against the Press and the imposition of complete censorship.

The constitution of India has provided Freedom of Speech and Expression for its citizens under Article 19(1)(a) of the constitution, which deals with fundamental rights. The Freedom of the Press or media, which is an influential medium of mass communication, is not specifically mentioned in this article; however, it is implied. In the debates of the constituent assembly, Dr. B R Ambedkar, Chairman of the Drafting Committee, made special reference to the concept of "Freedom of Press" and said, "that no special mention of the freedom of the press was necessary at all as the press and an individual as a citizen are same as far as their right of expression is concerned". Supreme Court upheld this in the Romesh Thaper vs. State of Madras and Brij Bhushan vs. State of Delhi cases.

The Right to freedom of the Press includes the freedom to print, publish, and disseminate one's thoughts, opinions, and viewpoints through all media without restriction. Three key components make up press freedom. They are:

1. Freedom of access to all sources of information.
2. Freedom of publication, and
3. Freedom of circulation.

However, press freedom is not unrestricted. Particularly the freedom of expression of Mass Media, which can influence a large section of society, which comprises not only heterogeneous social, cultural, and educational

backgrounds but is also super sensitive to religious and political needs. The technological revolution has gifted mankind with not only multiple access to media. Still, it has also made provisions for morphing, slanting, tainting, and faking the content, which needs to be monitored in this era of technological revolution, where a tremendous amount of information is available at the fingertips and can be accessed. The unauthenticated information being published by multiple media platforms needs to be monitored. Pre-independence, there were several regulations to curb the freedom of the Press or media. However, after its independence, India removed many of the regulations in force. Some examples are the Vernacular Press Act of 1878, The Censorship of Press Act of 1799, The Press Act of 1835, and the Metcalfe Act.

The Constitution of India has made provisions to safeguard the benefits of the fundamental Right provided under Art 19(1)(a) by Art 19(1)(2), which lays reasonable restrictions on the freedom of expression in the affairs influencing the Sovereignty and integrity of the State.

The Indian Constitution's Article 19(2) lists the following legitimate limitations on the Right to free speech and expression:

Sovereignty and integrity of the State: The argument was included by way of an amendment to calm down the agitated response of the people, which was calling for separate entities for the various regions of India.

Security of the State: It is forbidden to exercise freedom of expression in a way that compromises the state's security in any way. Ex: State of Bihar v. Shailabala Devi

Public Order: The Constitutional (First Amendment) Act of 1951 inserted the word public order. Ex: Romesh Thappar v. State of Madras, where the Court had ruled that the freedom of speech and expression includes the freedom of circulation.

Decency or morality: Sections 292 to 294 of the Indian Penal Code provide more detail on this defence. Ex: Ranjit Udeshi v. State of Maharashtra.

Contempt of Court: An act of disdain, disobedience, or interference with a court's orderly procedure is known as contempt of Court. Examples are disrupting court proceedings, interfering with attempts to obtain evidence, destroying evidence, disobeying a court order, and intimidating witnesses.

Defamation: Writing, publishing, and speaking a false statement that harms someone's reputation and good name for personal gain is defamation, which is both a criminal and a civil offence. The Law of Torts governs civil defamation remedies. The ability to speak and express oneself freely does not involve doing anything that can compromise someone's status. Defamation seriously constrains the Right to freedom of speech and expression since it injures someone's reputation. The Indian Penal Code, 1860's Sections 499 and 500 allow the victim to bring legal action for defamation against the offender.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Examine the Roles and Responsibilities of the Press while enjoying the freedom of expression in a multicultural, religious country like India.

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7.6 ATTEMPTS TO CURB FREEDOM OF MEDIA

A senior journalist, Kuldip Nayar, wrote to Mrs. Gandhi shortly after she declared the emergency, "If newspapers have criticized the government, it is largely because of its sluggish administration, slow progress in the economy field and the gap between promise and performance. My concept of a free press is to ferret out the truth and let the public know."

People's freedom of expression is crucial for maintaining a democratic way of life and for communicating their opinions to the general public. As an effective tool for mass communication, the media should be allowed to contribute freely to creating a robust, sustainable society. Denying media freedom directly relates to denying citizens the ability to shape public opinion.

There are numerous occasions where the government violated press freedom. For example, in *Sakal Papers v/s Union of India*, the Daily Newspapers (Price and Page) Order, 1960, which set the number of pages and size that a daily might publish at a price, was found to violate the freedom of the Press and to not be a reasonable constraint under Article 19(2). Similar to this, in *Bennett Coleman and Co. v. Union of India*, the Court ruled that the Newsprint Control Order, which set the maximum number of pages, was invalid because it violated Article 19(1)(a) and did not constitute a reasonable restriction under Article 19(2). The Government's argument that it would aid in the expansion of small newspapers was rejected by the Court.

Among many such attempts to curb the freedom of media, the imposition of emergency can be considered a major blow to the democratic situation in India and the media in particular.

Considering *Indian Express Newspapers Vs. Union of India* was related to interference from the authority in the circulation of newspapers. Speaking about the effectiveness of freedom of the Press regarding the content of circulation, the Court observed that expression means freedom from interference from authority. The Court's primary responsibility is to defend journalistic freedom. In the case of *Brij Bhushan v. the State of Delhi*, the validity of censorship was a point of discussion. An order was made in this case against the printer, publisher, and editor of the weekly *Organiser*. While many such cases are fought individually by respective newspapers or other

forms of media, a major threat to freedom of expression was experienced in India when the executive pillar of the country unanimously decided to curb the freedom of expression of the other three pillars of democracy.

7.6.1 Emergency and the Media

One of the most important instances of when freedom of the media was severely curbed was the declaration of an Internal Emergency in India in 1975. Mrs. Indira Gandhi, the then Prime Minister, following the Allahabad High Court judgment against her, decided to impose an emergency. The "darkest period" of independent India is often called the emergency period, which went on from June 25, 1975, to March 21, 1977. The rule limited the freedom of speech and expression and suspended all civil rights. The initial response to the emergency from mainstream media was shock. It was hard to believe that the Press and other pillars of democracy were under threat.

Interestingly, after the initial disbelief and protest, everyone bowed down to the pressure. In an interview, a senior political leaders L.K. Advani, a major opposition figure at the time who later served as a minister in the Morarji Desai and Atal Behari Vajpayee administrations, emphasized, "When Mrs. Gandhi asked the media to bend, they crawled". This quote effectively sums up a large portion of the media response. Apart from Newspapers, Radio and Cinema were the other popular mass media formats available. The government controlled the cinema content using the censor board. The government did not encounter resistance from All India Radio's staff because it was under the Ministry of Information and Broadcast's supervision.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Examine the status of the Press Freedom from the article 19(2)

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2. Make a brief note on the Status of the Press during the Emergency in India.

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7.7 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITY OF THE MEDIA IN A DEMOCRATIC ESTABLISHMENT

The constitutional makers of India did not offer any separate provision for the Right to speech and expression. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, the Chairman of the

Drafting Committee, powerfully argued that "The Press is simply another way of describing a citizen or an individual. The media has no superior privileges which are not to be given or which are not to be exercised by the voter in his separate capacity. The executive of the Press or the editor are all citizens. Therefore when they select to write in a newspaper, they are just exercising their Right to freedom of speech and expression, and in my decision then, no special mention is necessary of the freedom of the Press at all". Despite the Indian constitution not providing any special privilege to the media, the judicial procedures have promoted and safeguarded the freedom of the Press. Media being an influential tool of Mass Communication in a country like India, it must be an autonomous institution to effectively perform its function as the fourth pillar of a democratic setup.

7.7.1 Responsibility of Median in Democratic Country

Media need to play a pivotal role in building a society for a better tomorrow. Some of the responsibilities of media are:

1. Media should provide the public with fair and factual information.
2. Dissemination of knowledge that suits the structure of Indian society, which is multicultural and multilanguage. With a major part of its population still being illiterate and poor, it is essential to control information that lacks credibility and flows through various forms of mass media, including internet-based applications. Enabling people to form the right kind of opinion is the primary responsibility of the media.
3. The responsibility of the media is not just information and entertainment but also education. Content of Media should necessarily highlight the way against the people who are accused of any antisocial actions, irrespective of any political connection.
4. The content published should build the faith of people toward democracy and justice. Sensationalizing an event should be avoided.

7.7.2 Media's Role in Indian Democracy

Media, the backbone of a democratic setup, plays a significant role among the general public.

1. **Watchdog Function:** The media works as a watchdog about the various activities of the government and carry fair report.
2. **Information:** Provided information should educate the media consumer about various activities that occur in society, e.g., politics, sports, science, development, etc.
3. **Educate:** The media should highlight the loopholes in a democratic society. Awareness, thus created, will ultimately help the government be accountable and responsive, which is the true essence of a democratic setup.
4. **Opinion formation:** Media is an effective tool for disseminating information; the role of media is to create the right opinion based on

factual news.

5. The function of media is to provide the right kind of information related to critical subjects like childbirth, child care, domestic violence, sexual harassment, and many other similar sensitive areas that demand a break from stereotypical thoughts.
6. Media should emphasize providing information in an objective sense.
7. Revolutions in Information technology have brought a mammoth change in content and introduced various mass media formats. The content published on digital media like Facebook and Twitter and traditional media like print and audio-visual media play an important role in bringing in the desired social change. Ex: #metoo, stopping domestic violence, the importance of voting, and the plastic ban are some examples worth mentioning. The success of such campaigns highlights the content creation and positive use of the media for social change. When creating information appropriate for the social fabric, the wide reach and free dissemination of the internet and social media platforms are crucial components. It is interesting to observe the extensive use of new media platforms by political parties and government departments to promote the schemes. Such attempts can offer transparency in politics.

Check Your Progress 5

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Write briefly about the role and responsibility of the Press in India.

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7.8 LET US SUM UP

For any democratic country, freedom provided to the fourth estate is very essential. Freedom of expression provides scope for the free exchange of ideas as media inspires people to think beyond social norms and gives a platform to exchange ideas and thoughts. People who are in power often try to bury the facts from the common man, and in a democratic setup in which the people form for the people and of the people, the media attempts to uncover the truth, thus becoming the voice of the people. It is very important to remember that the media is an autonomous body. It can challenge the Legislative, Executive, and Judiciary decisions, considered the Constitution's primary pillars.

Media is considered as a public educator, and the revolutions in communication technology have enabled access to information without restriction. By educating the public, the media impacts practically every element of our public life. The media can be used to raise awareness of

various rural development programs and to advocate family planning.

7.9 FURTHER READINGS

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7.10 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. A democratic state is a political system where power is vested in the hands of the people, allowing citizens to participate in decision-making through free and fair elections, ensuring individual rights, and promoting the rule of law and equality for all.
2. Article 19(1)(a) is a fundamental right in India's Constitution that guarantees freedom of speech and expression to its citizens, enabling them to voice their opinions, share ideas, and access information without fear of censorship or suppression by the government or authorities.

Check Your Progress 2

1. The coordination between the four pillars of democracy is crucial for the effective functioning of a democratic state. Each pillar—executive, legislature, judiciary, and media—plays a distinct role in upholding democratic principles. Coordination ensures checks and balances, prevents abuse of power, and safeguards citizens' rights. The executive implements laws, the legislature enacts them, the judiciary interprets and upholds them, while the media informs the public and holds institutions accountable. Proper coordination fosters a robust democratic system that promotes transparency, accountability, and society's overall well-being.

Check Your Progress 3

1. In a multicultural and religious country like India, the press has significant roles and responsibilities while exercising freedom of expression. Firstly, the press should uphold the principles of impartiality and accuracy in reporting, ensuring that diverse perspectives are represented without bias. Secondly, they must be sensitive to cultural and religious sensitivities, avoiding content that could incite communal tensions or offend religious sentiments. Thirdly, the press should act as a watchdog, exposing corruption and malpractices, irrespective of political or religious affiliations. Lastly, responsible journalism is crucial to fostering a harmonious and inclusive society where the rights and dignity of all individuals are respected. By striking a balance between freedom of expression and cultural sensitivity, the press can play a pivotal role in nurturing India's democratic fabric and promoting social cohesion.

Check Your Progress 4

1. As per Article 19(2) of the Indian Constitution, reasonable restrictions can be imposed on the freedom of the press on certain grounds, such as public order, decency, morality, sovereignty, security of the state, friendly relations with foreign states, and defamation. These restrictions aim to strike a balance between protecting press freedom and preserving the larger interests of society and the nation.
2. Press freedom was severely curtailed during the Emergency in India (1975-1977). Censorship was imposed, and many media outlets faced government control, leading to a clampdown on critical reporting. Journalists were arrested, and newspapers critical of the government were shut down. This period marked a dark phase in Indian journalism, highlighting the importance of preserving media independence and freedom of expression in a democratic society.

Check Your Progress 5

1. The press in India plays a crucial role in upholding democracy and informing the public. Its primary responsibility is to provide citizens with accurate, fair, and unbiased information. The press acts as a watchdog, holding those in power accountable and exposing corruption and wrongdoing. It also plays a vital role in shaping public opinion, promoting constructive debates, and safeguarding the right to freedom of expression. Responsible journalism is essential in maintaining the public's trust and contributing to India's well-informed and participative society.

UNIT 8 MOBILE JOURNALISM

Structure

- 8.0 Introduction
- 8.1 Learning Outcomes
- 8.2 What is Mobile Journalism?
 - 8.2.1 Mobile Journalism and Citizen Journalists
 - 8.2.2 Strengths of Mobile Journalism
- 8.3 Tools and Accessories
 - 8.3.1 Equipment Required
 - 8.3.2 Mobile Applications
 - 8.3.3 Webcasting
- 8.4 Production Aspects of Mobile Journalism
 - 8.4.1 Shots
 - 8.4.2 Sequencing and Storyboards
- 8.5 Challenges of Mobile Journalism
- 8.6 Ethical Issues In Mobile Journalism
 - 8.6.1 Credibility
 - 8.6.2 Fake News
 - 8.6.3 Sensitivity
- 8.7 Let Us Sum Up
- 8.8 Further Readings
- 8.9 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

8.0 INTRODUCTION

As a journalism and mass communication student, you would have observed that journalists worldwide have adapted themselves to diverse technologies to excel in their profession. New technologies have immensely helped them to upgrade their professional skills and perform better in their vocation.

Mobile technology, in general, and smartphones, in particular, have helped them to make their jobs faster and more effective. Online editions and mobile applications of newspapers, magazines, radio and television, the newest newsgathering devices, have evolved and facilitated their performance over the years. Journalists have also progressed with the efficient support of the 3G and 4G-enabled Smartphones. Thus, smartphones have proved to be the real game changer in modern journalism.

Mobile journalism is fast emerging as a new creative trend in the media industry, revolutionising how news is gathered and disseminated to diverse audiences. Reporters and correspondents are trained to handle their mobile devices to broadcast news content using smartphones, tablets, digital cameras and laptops. Since the emergence of smartphones, news media personnel have become more mobile and independent. 'Pop-up' newsgathering has

become the order of the day in the media industry, where a single reporter can report from his/her beat.

In this Unit, we shall discuss the concept and opportunities of Mobile Journalism, also known as 'MoJo', and how it's different from Citizen Journalism. We shall also study the tools and accessories required for MoJo and its potential professional challenges. We will critically examine how reporters and news organisations use fast-emerging mobile devices to gather and disseminate news through diverse media forms.

8.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through this Unit, you should be able to:

- define mobile journalism;
- identify the tools needed for shooting, editing and distribution of the content for mobile journalism;
- describe the process of using smartphones for MoJo;
- outline opportunities and challenges of MoJo; and
- Critically assess the ethical issues in MoJo.

8.2 WHAT IS MOBILE JOURNALISM?

Mobile Journalism (MoJo) is a form of digital reporting where trained journalists use mobile devices to gather news. A mobile device refers to a Smartphone or a Tablet with iOS or Android operating systems. Reporters use mobile devices as tools to shoot, edit and broadcast news content. Media persons have become more mobile and independent in executing their assignments using Smartphones. It is gradually gaining popularity among reporters and news organisations as it helps organisations spend less on hiring crew and expensive equipment.

MoJo is cost-effective as smartphones are more convenient than traditional cameras, are heavy, and require additional human resources. Sometimes, sending Outside Broadcast Vans (OBV) to cover news breaks simultaneously at several spots is impossible. It is during such situations that smartphones come in handy for timely coverage of news occurrences. As smartphones are thoroughly equipped with in-built audio- video settings with different MoJo apps, reporters can quickly shoot, edit and upload their news content on the web or to their organisation.

8.2.1 Mobile Journalism and Citizen Journalists

The term 'Citizen Journalist' has become exceedingly popular in recent times. Newsrooms all over India, in fact, the world, have opened their doors for citizens to report civic, social, political and other reader-interest issues. Citizen Journalism has also helped establish vital links between the government and common people, as they offer suggestions to the government through various media platforms. Since it is not humanly possible for reporters to be present at every news location whenever a news event occurs, the citizens send reports of the event using their mobile phones. Television

news channels have often acknowledged the use of footage sent by citizen journalists, attributing the source.

From company executives to rickshaw pullers, vegetable vendors, and daily wage labourers, everybody can own a smartphone these days. Nowadays, Owning a smartphone has empowered the common people to express themselves more openly than ever before. This increased access to mobile phones has facilitated citizen journalists enormously to perform their jobs promptly. They can instantly record and upload the news event to web outfits or news media establishments. However, being responsible before uploading videos and audio is important, as truth and credibility are essential features of objective and ethical journalism. The same is expected from Mobile journalists, too. Verifying, checking and rechecking the facts under coverage is necessary before uploading.

8.2.2 Strengths of Mobile Journalism

It is often said that owning a smartphone is like carrying a portable newsroom. There are several occasions where breaking news has been flashed using mobile phones and exclusive news stories uploaded on the web worldwide.

MoJo is gradually becoming popular with journalists, media, and news broadcast organisations because of its various benefits. The work of a journalist has, of late, become much easier and faster, thanks to smartphones. The benefits of mobile journalism are that it is prompt, helps reporters beat deadlines, and is affordable. Also, smartphones are easier to carry, and trained reporters can broadcast breaking news or events from unlikely locations where broadcast crews find it hard to reach on time.

MoJos have captured shocking incidents and sights while happening and have drawn international attention. Accidents and disasters occur without warning; in such cases, smartphones capture the authentic moments of the story. There are numerous opportunities for mobile journalism where videos can capture historical moments instantly transmitted to the web. You may recall videos of people or cattle marooned in floods in different parts of the country or landslides in the hills of Uttarakhand captured on smartphones making their way into news bulletins.

Smartphones have made the lives of reporters easier as they have become 'mobile' in their work and can work independently without being assisted by a large production crew. It is also cost-effective for media organisations as they do not have to hire additional professionals and instead spend funds on modem equipment for improved production techniques.

Mobile journalists can also go to those places where it's challenging to place camera equipment and hold interviews with people who are uncomfortable to face the production crews. It has been observed that most people are willing to speak in front of smartphone cameras, while they get conscious or nervous in front of professional cameras with large crews. Even remotely, reporters can use their smartphones to cover news events without depending on computers or heavy broadcast equipment. The LIVE news broadcast with the

help of a smartphone is generally viewed as authentic coverage because people trust live reports of news events.

Mobile journalists must be first trained on using a smartphone for newsgathering, editing and broadcasting before being sent for field reporting. Once a reporter is trained in MoJo, it becomes convenient to telecast exclusive news from any corner of the world.

Activity-1

Identify some news items in a television news bulletin using smartphones. Analyse the types and focus of these stories.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What is Mobile Journalism?

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2. List some strengths of Mobile Journalism.

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8.3 TOOLS AND ACCESSORIES

While citizens can record any event, trained reporters must handle the smartphone camera for professionally appreciable results. They are expected to follow the process of news selection and collection and the ethics of journalism. The following are some equipment required for MoJo.

8.3.1 Equipment Required

Smartphones: Any smartphones with iOS and Android with good Internet connectivity can be used for MoJo. These days, smartphones are available with high-quality video and audio features.

Tablets: Tablets are also equipped with high-quality audio and video facilities to record so the news can be live-streamed easily.

Digital Cameras: Digital cameras, like smartphones, are light, convenient, and easy to carry. High-quality images and videos can be recorded using digital cameras and later conveniently transferred to computers and/or laptops for streaming online.

Tripod: For stability, a light tripod is required. A tripod mount is also needed

to support the smartphone.

Grips: It is attached to the tripod to move the camera around as you film.

Microphones: A clip-on microphone helps capture audio in a noisy and windy environment.

Video Light: All smartphones have built-in camera lights, but external light is also crucial for better results. However, natural light gives good results while shooting outdoors, compared to artificial light.

Power-Bank and Extra Batteries: Smartphone batteries do not last long when shooting videos. Therefore, carrying a power bank and extra batteries for shooting is always advisable.

Backpack: A light, sturdy backpack is needed to carry all the equipment.

8.3.2 Mobile Applications

Mobile Applications for MoJo are more valuable than other audio-video editing applications, which are convenient to learn and use by mobile journalists. To master the software, users have to be adequately trained. These apps help in recording, editing and distribution of news content.

8.3.3 Webcasting

Webcasting is the same as the LIVE broadcast of an event with the help of cameras. In webcasting, a mobile phone is used to do LIVE coverage of an event with the help of Social media platforms. Facebook, Twitter and YouTube are the popular social platforms where live streaming of videos can be done for news channels and independent reporters. Even mainstream mass media often rely on social media to reach their target audiences.

8.4 PRODUCTION ASPECTS OF MOBILE JOURNALISM

Shooting videos for journalism has to be taken seriously and done professionally. Reporters must follow specific rules while shooting and preparing storyboards, with proper sequencing. There are certain production aspects that every trained journalist needs to follow to produce quality news content.

8.4.1 Shots

While shooting for news content, knowing and presenting the shots professionally is essential. An image is a single photographed scene taken from continuous filming. It is a single piece of action taken by the camera. There are several types of shots.

Extreme Wide: It is also known as the 'establishing shot' - to show the viewer the surroundings of the scene being recorded.

Wide: Popularly known as a long shot, it includes a full view of the scene or shows a person's whole body from head to toe.

Mid-shot: A shot framing the person from their head to their knees.

Medium: Medium shots are usually taken during interviews or dialogue sequences. This shot is essential to capture the emotions and body language of the participants. This particular shot is aimed at showing the object from the head to the waistline.

Medium Close-up: The shot focuses on the face of the subject. It is taken from the head and cuts off around the chest. This shot, also commonly used during interviews, concentrates on the subject, not the surroundings. **Close-up:** This shot shows the subject from the head to the neck. The frame is filled with the subjects' faces, while it captures the emotions and expressions.

Extreme Close-up: This shot focuses on a particular part of the subject - such as the eyes. It frames only a part of the face to highlight the emotions during the interview.

Two-shot: This shot is often used in interviews to bring the interviewer and interviewee into the frame.

Over the Shoulder: The shot is taken from behind a person taking the interview on the subject and may also show the interviewer. The shot is commonly cut in between the conversations, alternating the two speakers' views.

Reverse over the Shoulder: The interviewer's frame is taken from over the shoulder of the interviewee.

Cutaways: During interviews, extra shots are taken of the hands and eyes engaged in an activity to create variety and give context to specific points in an interview. Cutaways can be taken for a maximum of 10 seconds because, during editing, only 3 or 4 seconds will be used for the content.

Overlay: The shot is taken of different scenes from internal and external locations that support the story. Overlay shots are important during edits.

8.4.2 Sequencing and Storyboards

Sequences are essential to support the visual narrative of the content. It is a well-established form of narrating the story with a video. Sequences are formed using different types of shots that we have discussed above.

Storyboards or Filming for Editing Shots: Storyboards are graphic illustrations of stories created before any film shot and are used in filmmaking, documentary making and dramatic films. The drawings are the sequence of shots to make the edit much more accessible. The series of graphic drawings is also known as filming for edit. Creating a storyboard for live events is impossible, but it's helpful when the story is offline and based on news content. A storyboard will have some of the following information:

Title of the story:

Date:.....

Sr. No.	Voiceover	Type of shots	Bytes

Those wishing to use MoJo professionally should read more in this upcoming area and attend seminars to enhance your skills to become successful MoJos.

Activity-2

Prepare a storyboard of a feature of two minutes duration on the implementation of Poshan Abhiyaan in a neighbouring area. Before proceeding with the shoot, write a voiceover description of the shots and bytes as explained above.

8.5 CHALLENGES OF MOBILE JOURNALISM

With the advent of 2 G, 3G, and 4G technologies in India, mobile companies are producing high-end smartphones at affordable costs. The prices of smartphones are quite competitive, and consumers have wide choices to pick and choose the brand of their preference. Let's discuss some of the challenges faced by MoJos.

Several technological, financial and logistical issues may arise while shooting with mobile phones. Some of these are listed below:

Battery Related: The average life of a smartphone battery is low, especially while shooting. To avoid abrupt disconnection during important shoots of an event, it is advisable to carry extra batteries and chargers. Solar batteries can be used to prevent such challenges. A power bank can also be helpful in such situations.

Quality of Shots (4K or HD): Mobile Journalists should be familiar with the quality and standard of shots. Whatever the medium of output is, it is highly important to shoot with 4K or high-definition cameras. 4K is also known as Ultra HD; its dimensions are 3840 x 2160 pixels. It is called 4K because its pixel size is four times the resolution of HD, which has a pixel size of 1920 x 1080 pixels. While shooting with mobile phones, the format should be set before the shoot commences. When buying mobile phones, checking for high-resolution cameras is essential.

Internet-Related Issues: Despite the fourth-generation 4G-network connectivity, sometimes, due to poor networks, journalists have to face problems in broadcasting live news content. Uninterrupted Internet connectivity is essential while covering a live event or managing live chats. Without Internet connectivity, it becomes challenging to execute the job.

Reporting Challenging Situations: MoJos may face uncertain situations. For example, while covering protest demonstrations or riots where police or agitators indulge in violent clashes, police may use water canons to thwart the agitators. The reporters could become victims of such circumstances in which expensive reporting equipment and smartphones could be damaged or destroyed. Covering the smartphone with a waterproof casing is advisable to safeguard one's equipment and gadgets during such situations. Selfie sticks and mobile tripods should also be taken adequate care of.

Additionally, reporters may be unable to send live feeds to their stations. If there is no connectivity, reporters can look for a place where there is a

Broadband connection or a Wi-Fi facility. If reporters cannot send live feeds, they can record the events and send the tapes or the clips later when internet connectivity is restored.

Theft of mobile phones: In the event of theft, valuable inputs and news recordings already collected may get lost; therefore, it is always advisable to keep mobile phones safe to avoid theft or loss. The recording should be transferred to Google Drive or saved in a pen drive. An extra mobile phone helps during emergency situations.

Quality and Cost of Smartphones: The prices of smartphones are currently very competitive, but the quality of cameras can often be compromised. Smartphones are designed to be user-friendly, with diverse inbuilt applications which feature advanced audio-video settings. People can shoot images and videos and share them with social media subscribers, thereby becoming active social media reporters and citizen journalists. While the common people are free to choose any smartphone, MoJos should not compromise on the quality of the cameras. They should survey the market before opting for a brand of smartphone that is equipped with an inbuilt high-resolution camera and supports the apps needed for production and editing.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What are the challenges of Mobile Journalism?

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2. What points should be kept in mind while buying a smartphone for MoJo?

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8.6 ETHICAL ISSUES MOBILE JOURNALISM

As discussed in the previous sections, Mobile Journalism has emerged as an integral part of journalism today. Hence, specific professional standards of journalism must be adhered to during gathering and broadcasting new or option pieces.

8.6.1 Credibility

Though reporters have the freedom to shoot and film, edit and broadcast news coverage through smartphones, the standards of professional journalism

must be maintained at all times. Multifarious skills and deep knowledge of regional and national issues for journalists are essential to approaching the right source of information, reporting it accurately and following the basic rules of news reporting.

Reporters should consider smartphones a newsgathering tool and must not forget the basic tenets of news writing. If a mobile journalist does not follow professional regulations, s/he could be accused of defying fundamental norms of professional journalism. The Information Technology Act, the Official Secrets Act, and laws relating to defamation, contempt of legislature, and contempt of court are some of the most stringent laws that must be abided by at any cost. Any infringement of any of these could cause serious damage to the credibility of the news organisation and the MoJo reporting stories containing any such elements.

8.6.2 Fake News

Fake news is one of the biggest threats to the news industry today. The Internet is flooded with information on social media platforms, so it is essential to separate genuine videos from fake ones. Many fake videos go viral and may lead to heinous crimes such as lynching, abduction, and rape, followed by murders or suicides. Therefore, the role of a trained MoJo reporter would be to comprehend the credibility of the news content and check and recheck the accuracy of the subject being covered.

MoJo reporters should endeavour to be impartial and fair in their narrative. While covering news stories, they should contact as many sources and parties involved as possible. Unauthorised and non-licensed versions of mobile applications should not be used. The credibility of the content is significant. Therefore, it becomes imperative for trained reporters to use apps with great caution and take due care while shooting and editing journalistic content.

8.6.3 Sensitivity

MoJos are often compelled to work under tremendous pressure. However, they should not be overwhelmed by the situation around them and unduly dramatise the events, which might deviate from the actual situation. While covering serious events, such as rapes, murders, road accidents or other heinous crimes, proper precautions should be taken. Reporters should not reveal the identities of victims of sexual harassment or their relatives. It is always safe to avoid live coverage, and footage not allowed by law should not be shared or uploaded on the web.

Reporters must know how, where and where they should capture videos. Though pushing the red button on the mobile phone to capture critical moments and sensitive times is very tempting, it is better to restrict oneself from transmitting any such information which might pose serious threats to the public and national security. They should strictly follow the Press Council of India and other regulatory bodies' guidelines.

Activity-3

Conduct an interview of 2 minutes duration with a public figure in your area, with the help of your mobile phone. Note that care needs to be taken so that the interviewer and interviewee are visible in the frames (a Selfie stick of your mobile phone will be helpful in this exercise).

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. Why should Mobile Journalism follow the codes of ethics of journalism?

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2. What is 'fake news'?

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3. How fake news can be identified?

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8.7 LET US SUM UP

In this Unit, you were exposed to different aspects of mobile journalism, a form of digital reporting using mobile devices. You have also learned the strengths of MoJo and how it can be optimally utilised to create news content using professional formats and techniques. Some challenges that mobile journalists face and issues related to the authenticity and credibility of mobile journalism, including its ethical aspects, were also explained.

While smartphones enable users to take video shots of whatever is happening around them, it has propelled media experts to understand the complexities of news being circulated without any firm basis and truth. Therefore, specific essential criteria need to be followed by Journalists. In this regard, it was emphasised that mobile journalists should consider smartphones as just a look for gathering news content and take adequate care in reporting. The report should be accurate, unbiased and obtained ethically without violating any rules or laws of the land. Contacting the authorities for their permission is always advisable to avoid legal issues.

8.8 FURTHER READINGS

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8.9 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. Mobile Journalism, or MoJo, is a form of digital reporting in which trained journalists use mobile devices to gather news. A mobile device may be a smartphone or tablet with iOS or Android operating systems.
2. MoJo is gradually gaining popularity among reporters and news organisations as news content can be quickly shot, edited and broadcast with just one mobile device. The growing popularity of MoJo can be attributed to the use of a single mobile device for newsgathering. Smartphones have made the lives of reporters much easier as they can work independently without depending on a large production crew. They can also use smartphones to cover news events without depending on computers or heavy camera equipment. It is also cost-effective for media organisations that need not hire many professionals.

Check Your Progress 2

1. Mobile Journalism has some technical, logistical and financial challenges. The average battery life of smartphones drains fast during video shooting, and the reporter could miss crucial shots while filming if the battery runs out. It is, therefore, advisable to carry extra batteries and chargers. Solar batteries can be used in this regard. For various reasons, internet connectivity may get completely cut off. In such situations,

reporters cannot send live feeds to their stations.

2. Markets are flooded with smartphones of varied qualities and features. While buying a phone for MoJo, one should ensure to buy a good quality phone with a high-resolution camera, and the device should support apps which may be needed for production and editing.

Check Your Progress 3

1. Mobile Journalism follows the process of gathering news and broadcast content and high standards of journalism. Reporters should consider smartphones a tool for gathering news content and follow all journalism ethics. The report should be accurate, unbiased and obtained ethically without violating any rules or laws as per the constitution of India.
2. Fake news has become a great menace and threat to the news industry worldwide. Fake news is misinformation and often lacks credibility or a reliable source. With the massive amount of information available on the Internet, it is difficult to differentiate between real and fake news. The role of a trained MoJo reporter would be to understand the accuracy of news content and conduct research on the subject to be filmed.
3. Fake news can be identified by checking the content and the source from where it is coming and cross-checking the information received from other sources.

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UNIT 9 TECHNOLOGICAL EMPOWERMENT AND MUZZLED PRESS

Structure

- 9.0 Introduction
- 9.1 Learning Outcomes
- 9.2 Technological Change and the Media as an Industry
- 9.3 Understanding Technological Empowerment
- 9.4 Technological Empowerment Vs Media
- 9.5 The Muzzled Press
- 9.6 Influence of Technology on Freedom of the Press
- 9.7 Let Us Sum Up
- 9.8 Further Readings
- 9.9 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

9.0 INTRODUCTION

We have learnt media should enjoy its freedom to express. This thought provides a clue that the media sector and its observers look to media primarily in terms of content and its creation. On the other hand, technology that facilitates media in its three-dimensional work *viz* content, devices that display the content (medium format), and distribution system is accorded secondary status. Although the industry has underplayed its dependence on technology, it is quite evident that advances in technology from the first day of its invention have facilitated the growth of the media as an industry and provided a competitive edge to the working method. This chapter will attempt to understand the relationship between technological empowerment and the media industry. The chapter explores the industry's symbolic relationship with technology by tracing the developments that have shaped and given birth to newer media formats. It also checks if the newer platforms have facilitated media in improving its status towards freedom to express.

9.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- understand the significance of media freedom and its role in content creation and expression, recognising the primary focus of media and its observers;
- recognise the integral role of technology in the media industry, encompassing content creation, medium formats, and distribution systems, and its impact on facilitating industry growth and competitiveness;
- examine the historical developments in technology that have shaped and given rise to newer media formats and evaluate their implications on the industry's relationship with technological empowerment; and

- analyse the influence of newer platforms on media's ability to improve its status towards freedom of expression, gauging the extent to which technology enhances media's capacity to express itself effectively.

9.2 TECHNOLOGICAL CHANGE AND THE MEDIA AS AN INDUSTRY

The influence of technology on media has been significant and dramatically changed how we consume and share news and entertainment. Here are a few examples:

1. **Digitalisation of Media:** The development of digital technology has transformed the media landscape, leading to the creation of digital platforms and tools. News publishers, broadcasters, and entertainment companies now leverage digital platforms to reach a global audience. Traditional print and broadcast media are now competing with online media platforms, which are more accessible and convenient.
2. **Social Media:** Social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram have revolutionised how people communicate and share information. Social media has become essential for journalists to share news stories and engage with audiences. It has also enabled citizen journalism, allowing anyone with a smartphone to capture and share news and information.
3. **AI and Data Analytics:** Advances in Artificial Intelligence (AI) and data analytics have enabled media companies to understand their audience better, improve user experience, and personalise content. Examples of AI in daily life are Alexa, Google Assistant, and Siri, which work on an intelligent voice recognition system.

AI has also created software that can write news stories automatically, freeing up journalists to focus on more in-depth reporting. AI plays a significant role in media houses, facilitating easy access to desired information and checking fake news.

Data Analytics facilitates the management of big data. Ex: Reactions of people during the COVID situation, public sentiments during elections. Data Analytics tools enable understanding and analysing the big data procured from various platforms.

However, it is essential to remember that AI cannot respond to the public's sentiments and will have its standard writing format. AI can be used to gather information primarily, and the final copy should be the responsibility of a content writer.

4. **Virtual Reality:** Virtual Reality (VR) and Augmented Reality (AR) technologies have opened up new possibilities for storytelling and entertainment. News organisations can now create immersive news experiences, allowing viewers to experience stories 360 degrees. Entertainment companies can create interactive VR experiences that let users become part of the story.

In conclusion, technology has significantly impacted the media industry, transforming how we consume and share news and entertainment. Integrating technology with media has created new opportunities, brought new challenges, and changed the fundamental nature of journalism and entertainment.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. On YouTube, keep searching for videos on the topic that interests you. Write down your observations.

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2. Watch a television news program and check the adaptation of VR in the newsroom. Make an analysis.

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9.3 UNDERSTANDING TECHNOLOGICAL EMPOWERMENT

Technology empowerment refers to the ability of technology to enhance the capabilities and opportunities of individuals, organisations, and societies. Technology empowerment is a means to level the playing field and provide equal opportunities for all in a world where technology is becoming increasingly integrated into our daily lives. By using technology to access education, healthcare, and financial resources, people can improve their quality of life and achieve more tremendous success.

From a media perspective, technology empowerment can be understood as how technology can improve people's lives by providing access to information, resources, and communication. Technology empowerment can also refer to the ability of an individual and the organisation to use and harness technology effectively and efficiently for their benefit. This includes having the knowledge and skills to use technology and the ability to innovate and create new technologies that can facilitate providing better media content to consumers.

9.4 TECHNOLOGICAL EMPOWERMENT VS MEDIA

The media industry has thoroughly enjoyed technological innovations. From the time printing was first discovered to the present day of digital printing, there has been a tremendous change. The technology has not only helped in better quality printing but also in the circulation of newspapers. Similarly, the advantage of communication technology has helped accommodate breaking news and stories. Creating new videos, spreading the news via social media, and growing our audiences have never been easier.

A retrospective glance at the growth of the media industry provides us with one particular clue: as technology grows, it takes away the older format. Innumerable innovations have brought advantages to the media and its men. A newer version could arrive when we finish reading the chapter. Among the many technological innovations that have arrived in the market and are extensively beneficial to the functioning of media, we will try to identify some here:

1. Data Network Speed

Internet speed is one of the biggest considerations as it determines how quickly you can perform tasks online and how many tasks your network can handle simultaneously. Super-fast wireless technology has changed the working method and access to media. With the present generation gadgets supporting 5G data network speed, one can imagine the work culture of today's media. Data is being delivered at nearly 10 gigabits per second, thus making live streaming of video a flawless experience.

It's also poised to help usher in mainstream virtual and augmented reality. The high-speed network facilitates live streaming of any event.

2. Wi-fi: Wireless networking

Wireless networking is commonly installed in all media houses today. The technology assists in improved data communication between the departments of media. The technology allows the user to transfer the required data while on the move or sitting at a fixed place, along with other advantages like cost savings as investments in cables are minimal. Since the connection is password-protected, the systems and data remain secure.

3. Spy Cameras/ Drones

A spy camera is a device capable of capturing video (and sometimes audio) of a location without the subjects' knowledge. Although they are occasionally used for commercial purposes, spy cameras are mainly used for surveillance activities.

4. Virtual Reality

Virtual Reality, or VR as it is popularly called technology, can enhance the quality of media productions. VR is extensively used in cinemas. But in all forms of visual media. The ultimate level of newsroom interaction can be witnessed with the help of Virtual Reality (techniques). VR

promises to provide the viewer with the highest experience of an interesting story. VR video experience builds a deeper level of connectedness and empathy with news stories, e.g., Flood situations, historical excavations, etc.

5. Ad Blocking

Advertisements are bread earners for media, while they are not so welcome by the viewer who is watching his favourite TV show or a movie on YouTube. Ad blockers are applications that enable or alter advertising content on a webpage. Ad blockers are applications (plugins or browser extensions) that remove or change the advertising on the web platform that the consumer is using. Consumers of today can use software to Ad block.

Interestingly, while the consumer is looking for ad blockers, manufacturers are managing to develop ad-blocking systems. Ex: Apple came with content blockers which could be downloaded from the Apple store.

6. Automated Journalism

Automated journalism is also known as **algorithmic journalism** or **robot journalism**. It is a term that attempts to describe modern technological processes that have infiltrated the journalistic profession. It is a technology that assists in generating news articles, features, or books. Automated Journalism can be used mainly in content production, Data Mining, content optimisation and news dissemination.

Using Artificial Intelligence (AI) software, the stories are produced by computers. These programs interpret, organise, and present data in human-readable ways. Typically, the process involves an algorithm that scans large amounts of provided data and selects from various pre-programmed article structures. The output can be customised to suit the style of a newspaper, writer, or even voice.

One of the apps trending today is Chat GPT, which is one of the industry's most controversial emerging technologies. Journalists or writers, by feeding the model with structured data, can quickly and accurately generate a news story. The app can be used to write material on any topic, thus minimising the need for an expert commentator or writer in a related field. Chat GPT is extensively used to fact-check the information received and compare and verify social media posts.

The app lends a helping hand to content creators. The author, who could also be a journalist, has to provide suitable keywords to receive the material. The AI will interpret and analyse the data before producing the content, apart from facilitating the reporter's in-depth analysis of the issue.

AI can be used to arrive at suitable headlines, test headlines, source information, and identify trending stories. The content developer could be limited to checking the content once before publication. AI, in turn, may reduce the dependency on human resources and harm the creative mind. The other challenge is that the app will not be able to understand

human emotions and, hence, cannot do justice to the story, which needs to be written after understanding the context.

Early adopters of Robotic Journalism include news providers like the Associated Press, Thomson and Reuters, and Forbes.

7. Social outreach apps

Social media outreach uses social networks like Facebook, Twitter and LinkedIn to publish content and raise awareness on a particular issue. Content creators can go beyond the usual aspects of Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram to get consumer perspectives, as outreach enables content engagement or building new relationships. Social outreach apps bring a fresh take on how the media industry engages with its audience. The apps also help to connect people who are working on similar concerns. Some Examples of social outreach apps: Nextdoor, Citizen, Be My Eyes, Charity Miles, Paperweight, and Too Good to Go are some examples that are popular among users. The content will bring interesting stories to the consumers.

8. Scrollytelling

Scrollytelling is an innovative method of presenting online content, including text, images, videos, and interactive elements, in a storytelling format that encourages users to scroll through the information vertically. With scrolly-telling, users can engage with the content by exploring the narrative in their own way and at their own pace. The online content is very engaging and informative. Usage of scrolly-telling includes creating a long form of articles or interactive infographics, but it is also used in virtual tours and games. Scrollytelling can also be used for virtual tours, timelines, and games. Using scrolly-telling, content creators can provide users with a unique and immersive experience, making online content more engaging and informative. Additionally, it may feature advanced design elements such as parallax scrolling, GIFs, and animations.

8. Wearable Media

Wearable technology is designed to be worn by the consumer. Some common types of wearable technology include smartwatches and smart glasses. The gadgets are close to the surface of the skin and transmit the data by detecting and analysing it with the help of a sensor.

Wearable technology offers a wide range of possible uses, from communication and entertainment to improving health and fitness. Consumers wearing accessories that enable them to access content is wearable media. Apple initially started the concept of wearable media. Wearable technology is changing the way consumers access content. The Apple Watch makes getting the latest news as easy as telling the time. Wearable journalism is ideal for quick updates until viewers get the full story. From clothing to contact lenses, wearable journalism presents the opportunity to deliver content in trimmed-down formats without losing the essence of the story.

9. Video creation technology

Audio Visual media format is today's demand. Creating videos has been made easy using various apps. With most media having converted themselves to transmedia format, it is now essential for every content creator to understand the techniques of creating short videos about their work.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. With the assistance of Chat GPT, gather information on Ancient Indian Scientists and check the credibility of the content.

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2. Explore different Video creation apps. Prepare a 30-second video capsule on street food.

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9.5 THE MUZZLED PRESS

The muzzled press refers to a situation where the press or media is restricted in reporting or sharing information freely. This can happen for various reasons, including censorship, government control, corporate influence, and legal threats. In such situations, the press may not be able to fulfil its role as a watchdog of society and provide accurate and unbiased news to the people. A free press should function in its true sense, as such an action will ensure transparency, accountability, and credibility in a democratic system.

9.6 INFLUENCE OF TECHNOLOGY ON FREEDOM OF THE PRESS

From time immemorial, we have observed technology plays an important role in news distribution. However, it is important to understand that the two cannot be treated synonymously as news distribution is a sociotechnical enterprise wherein political economy and strategic organisational practices shape technology's influence on news distribution patterns. For example, television's advent brought predictions of cinema halls' death. The cinema and the present-day OTT platforms gradually provided new methods of releasing and viewing cinema.

The transmedia of today depends on multiple technological support for news

distribution. Media is focused on issues and concepts like platform dependency, the materiality of networks, transparent intermediaries, and social distribution. Apart from the concepts related to media organisation, technology has also played a major role in the reconceptualisation of the audience. Media content is personalised, and the technology has also created opportunities for audiences to engage and collaborate with journalists. Platforms like Facebook and functionality like user comments on websites have lowered barriers to interactions between journalists and their audiences. Moreover, there has been a cultural shift over the past decade among journalistic actors from suspicion of interest in audience participation. Non-journalists demonstrated their ability to coproduce and amplify news content during emergencies and other fluid situations and encourage the audience to participate.

A free press is essential for a healthy and functioning democracy. Innovations in the field of technology have made it easier for journalists to collect and disseminate information. With digital tools like smartphones and digital cameras, reporters can document events and share real-time information with their audiences without the need for large production teams or traditional media outlets. For example, social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and YouTube have provided an alternative platform for journalists and citizens to disseminate news, information, and opinions. These platforms have also helped to expose instances of censorship and suppression of the press in different parts of the world, allowing people to stay informed even in countries with heavily censored press.

We observe that technology has created new opportunities for the press to disseminate information, making it easier for people to access information, even in places where the press may be muzzled. However, it has also created new challenges, such as the challenge of verifying and fact-checking information in a world where misinformation and fake news are rampant.

Despite the arrival and advantages of technology, unfortunately, for various reasons, press freedom continues to be threatened and eroded. Michael Vatikiotis, a writer, journalist and private diplomat working in Southeast Asia since 1987, observes journalists working for various media formats continue to face threats. In addition to the laws governing the freedom of the media, the journalists continue to face attempts of bribery in the form of cash, gifts and awards. The media persons also receive threatening phone calls.

Supporting Michael Vatikiotis's observations, the reports released by the Reporters Without Borders (RSF) Press Freedom Index measures the degree of freedom available to journalists in 180 countries. Until 2021, the mean average score for all countries worsened, rising from 36.3 to 38. The latest RSF index for 2022 shows that only 8 out of 180 countries provide a good environment for journalism. Interestingly, the status of press freedom, even in countries like the UK, France, the USA and Canada, remains satisfactory. While Russia's situation is serious, North Korea is ranked lowest.

Although technology has played a significant role in providing an alternative platform for the press to disseminate information and has helped to combat the effects of press censorship and suppression and the use of digital

technologies such as social media, blogs, citizen journalism, and other online platforms has enabled people to share information and ideas more freely and independently, the technology has affected the functioning of media. The threat can be summarised in the following way:

1. Online harassment

The harassment of journalists isn't a new threat. Digital technology and the presence of journalists on various social media platforms have made the consumers of media track the men working for media. One part of the public harasses journalists by writing emails and instant messaging on social media platforms. The worst situation is doxing – where the public shares private or identifiable information about the media persons online. The coming together of press haters forming a network online can be called "mob censorship". The public comments on the gender, race, ethnicity, sexuality and religion of the media person. The effect of such action could often lead to self-censoring the work or avoiding covering certain topics.

2. Surveillance of Journalists

Surveillance can be considered one of the professional traits of an investigative journalist to monitor people's activities using various methods. Following the activities critically, intercepting letters and telephone tapping the person under observation was common for journalists. Surveillance also significantly impacts the anonymous sources and whistle-blowers that journalists rely on to investigate governments and large institutions. With the arrival of information technology, surveillance can be done on a mass scale and from any location. The methods commonly used are hacking, data interception and installing spyware.

Interestingly, once considered a step towards investigative journalism, surveillance has taken reverse gear. Philip Di Salvo highlights the impact of digital surveillance on journalists in a 2021 article, "Investigative Journalists and Internet Surveillance". The article examines the threat surveillance has on journalists' safety and the restrictions it puts on their work. Anthony L. Fargo, in his article The End of the Affair", examines how mass surveillance threatens the relationships between journalists and their sources.

Mass surveillance is likely to be an ongoing threat to the freedom of the press, even in a democratic setup. Digital technology provides scope for the authorities to monitor the population. For example, the provision in surveillance Law allows enforcement agencies to access citizens' Internet and telecommunication usage data.

3. Censorship of Digital Content

It can be recollected that during the COVID pandemic, the governments issued an order against spreading any news or content which could instigate fear or stimulate unwanted reactions among the public. Creating or even forwarding, particularly on social media platforms, was considered a crime. Instances such can be considered as censorship of

digital content. Though such action was desirable during the pandemic, the instance provides us with a clue that the messages are being scrutinised and observed. For example, Facebook removes posts from an individual's account, which it considers not good for the health of society.

4. Migration to a non-journalist post

A journalist who feels he/she cannot match the expected compromises may not want to continue in the profession. He/she might prefer to take up any other alternative employment.

5. Birth of Fake News

We have seen the existence of News Agencies that supply news to media houses on subscription. Using technology, companies have come into existence to provide hyper-local stories to media outlets by 2012. The stories are produced using fake by-lines. The researcher, writer and editor could be different, and the person could be sitting in a different location while writing a story. Journatic and Blockshopper.com are some examples. However, the problematic part about fake news content production is that newspapers that subscribe to the services of such online companies fire their human resources.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. Examine the implications of technology on the freedom of expression aspect of a journalist.

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9.7 LET US SUM UP

Technology has played an important role in the historical development of journalism. For example, the telegraph helped foster the development of newswire services and the proliferation of computers replaced typewriters. Today, the linkage between technology and journalism is as deep and complex as ever. Technologies have transformed key aspects of contemporary news production, distribution, and consumption apart from challenging the foundational theories of mass communication. The technological revolution has led to the development of new forms of media which demand specific methods while creating content apart from technology. Limitations of words and a combination of AV media provide a transmedia look to every social media platform.

Technology has been key in developing new logic and forms for news production or taking something perceived as newsworthy. It has provided

shape and direction to the concept of News and to the actors, actants, and activities related to the news.

Lewis and Westlund (2016) identify four dimensions of newsgathering. They are:

Human-centric journalism: Here, technology has a limited impact on journalistic activities.

Technology-supported journalism: Human actors are largely autonomous relative to technological actants. A majority of today's mainstream media functions on this dimension. **Technology-infused journalism:** Highlights the institutionalisation of technology for news production and distribution. This form has become more prominent in recent years. An example of that is ambient journalism. In ambient journalism, stress is gathering and communicating news information drawn from streams of collective intelligence made available through social media platforms.

Technology-oriented journalism: Human actors and technological actants become interdependent in this form. An example is automated journalism, a form of journalism governed by human-created algorithms that automate some stages of news production to fasten journalistic products.

A working journalist enjoys the right to protect the identities of their confidential sources. While technology's influence, including the use of artificial intelligence, in journalism is meant to aid journalists and provide readers with quality news, it can create more significant difficulties for journalists and change how people consume their news. Whether they know it or not. Journalists and news sources should move forward cautiously when using artificial intelligence to produce news articles. Relies on an inconsistent set of court decisions based on constitutional and common law interpretations and state statutes. Efforts to bring consistency to federal law through the passage of a shield law have stalled. At the same time, journalists face new threats because of the vulnerability of their communications to discovery and monitoring by third parties. Also, the entry of non-professional communicators into the news ecosystem is causing courts to re-evaluate and redefine long-standing protections. This article proposes four ways that sources could be better protected from unmasking without the passage of a shield law: improving whistle-blower laws to protect better people who report illegal or unethical actions to the media; vastly reducing the number of government secrets to making "leaking" less attractive or necessary; changing legal strategy to focus on protecting the anonymity of sources instead of the rights of journalists to keep secrets, and more widespread and intelligent use of encrypted applications and software could all improve the security of journalistic sources. Because of the complexity of amending multiple whistle-blower protection laws and changing the government's document classification system, the best solution is to persuade news organisations to change legal tactics and use better encryption technology.

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9.9 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1 & 2 – as per your observations

Check Your Progress 2

1 & 2 – as per your observations

Check Your Progress 3

The implications of technology on the freedom of expression aspect of a journalist are multifaceted. On one hand, technology has expanded the reach and accessibility of information, empowering journalists to disseminate news and opinions more widely. It has enabled citizen journalism, allowing ordinary individuals to report on events and share their perspectives. Additionally, digital tools and social media platforms offer new expression and audience engagement avenues.

However, technology also brings challenges. With the rise of digital media,

misinformation and fake news spread rapidly, making it difficult for journalists to distinguish between credible sources and misinformation. Online harassment and threats can impede journalists' freedom to express their views without fear of reprisals. Moreover, surveillance and data privacy concerns can lead to self-censorship among journalists, fearing potential repercussions for their reporting.

In conclusion, while technology has expanded the freedom of expression for journalists, it also presents challenges that must be navigated carefully to uphold journalistic integrity and ensure responsible reporting in the digital age.



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UNIT 10 ALGORITHMS AND AI FOR JOURNALISM

Structure

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10.0 INTRODUCTION

In continuation to the technological empowerment and muzzled press in unit 9, you will be able to learn how algorithms and artificial intelligence (AI) promise the field of journalism another leap forward.

Technologically advanced countries keep conducting innovations predominantly focusing on computer-based deep learning, machine learning and artificial intelligence. Some European countries, mainly America and China, are leading in research and inventing AI applications and tools. The Internet, social media, and mobile communication have already provided new tools and pathways for journalism to meet the profound challenges of the digital age.

Newsrooms in media houses worldwide are adopting artificial intelligence for their media professional practices. Incorporating AI technologies in media houses, such as automated content creation, moderation, and speech-to-text programs, not only revolutionises the media industry but also enriches the media profession. Applications of various forms of AI in newsgathering, news production and distribution have already started in Western countries.

10.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After working through this Unit, you will be able to:

- know the concept of emerging media technology, the technological determinism theory and the difference between old media and new media;
- understand how AI algorithms work and the advantages and disadvantages of AI algorithms in the field of journalism;
- analyse the technical skills which are prerequisites for media professionals and how Artificial Intelligence frees journalists to work on creating better journalism;
- learn about Artificial Intelligence tools, AI-powered writing and how these tools help journalists solve their problems; and
- anticipate the impact of Algorithms and AI technology on future journalism;

10.2 EMERGING MEDIA TECHNOLOGY

10.2.1 Overview

In the past few generations, we have been in traditional media, but that has remained; instead, it is augmented by new technologies. We have been transformed from print and broadcast media to digital media, including email, websites, social media platforms, and online streaming services. Our development agendas and social, economic, and political focus have shifted from industrialisation to information technology. Since the beginning of the 21st century, you have been engrossed in digital technology and its platforms.

In this highly dynamic landscape, emerging media have an increasingly vital role to play in the world of journalism. Let us explore emerging media and how media marketers can use it to their advantage. Emerging media are communication formats or channels that are becoming part of society's communication architecture. It took decades before an emerging medium became an established medium, and even then, the new medium was often in

a constant state of refinement and innovation. Younger generations are increasingly cutting the cable cord and moving to TV streaming services. Podcasts have cornered a segment of the radio market. Newspapers and magazines are moving from paper editions to online publications. Not to mention that your marketing mindset has changed, which means you are now almost firmly ensconced in the digital age (MSS media, 2023).

10.2.2 Technological Determinism

Technological determinism is the belief in technology as a key governing force in society. It seeks to show technical developments, media, or technology as the key mover in history and social change. According to Mihaly Heder (2021), "Technological determinism is that a society's technology progresses by following its own internal logic of efficiency while determining the development of the social structure and cultural values". The term is believed to have originated from Thorstein Veblen (1857–1929), an American sociologist and economist. However, the first major elaboration of a technological determinist view of socioeconomic development came from the German philosopher and economist Karl Marx, who argued that changes in technology, and specifically productive technology, are the primary influence on human social relations and organisational structure and that social relations and cultural practices ultimately revolve around the technological and economic base of a given society. Marx's position has become embedded in contemporary society, where the idea that fast-changing technologies alter human lives is pervasive.

10.2.3 New Media

"New Media" refers to computational media sharing material online and through computers. The new media technologies, sometimes known as Web 2.0, include a wide range of web-related communication tools such as blogs, wikis, online social networking, virtual worlds, and other social media platforms (Linda et al., 2008). New media is described as communication technologies that enable or enhance interaction between users and users - content (Ronald Rice, 1984). In the middle of the 1990s, the phrase "new media" became widely used as part of a sales pitch for the influx of interactive CD-ROMs for entertainment and education.

New media inspire new ways of thinking about older media, such as broadcast television programmes, feature films, newspapers, magazines, and books. You can identify the difference between new media: how they specifically refashion traditional/older media and how older media refashion themselves to meet the challenges of new media. Unless the old media contain technologies that enable digital generative or interactive processes, they are not considered to be new media.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What do you understand about the concept of emerging media technology?

2. What is meant by technological determinism?

3. What are the differences between old media and new media?

10.3 ALGORITHMS IN MEDIA

10.3.1 Defining Algorithms

An algorithm is a set of instructions for calculations or other operations. This applies to both mathematics and computer science. It is a procedure for solving any problem. Algorithms is a well-defined sequential computational technique that accepts a collection of values as input and produces the output needed to solve a problem. An algorithm is a systematic procedure that produces the answer to a question or solves a problem in a finite number of steps. The name derives from the Latin translation in the 9th century.

Do you know what is Machine Learning (ML)? Machine Learning is the study of computer algorithms that can improve automatically through experience and using data. Machine learning algorithms build a model based on sample data, known as training data, to make predictions or decisions without being explicitly programmed. ML is seen as a part of artificial intelligence.

Why do we need Algorithms? As we discussed, algorithms are used to solve problems or automate tasks systematically and efficiently. They are a set of instructions or rules that guide the computer or software in performing a particular task or solving a problem.

Example 1: You know the clock is ticking, but you do not know how the clock is working. It would help to learn how the manufacturer sets those nuts and bolts. The hands of the clock keep on moving every second, minute and hour. In the process of working the clock, there must be a set of rules and an algorithm behind it.

Example 2: When you are cooking your favourite food, the recipe, a sequential procedure must be followed. It is the recipe that turns raw material

into a favourite food. This is what an algorithm is, following a procedure to get the desired output. The sequence is the most important thing to follow to get what you want.

Characteristics of Algorithms: You can find below a few of the main characteristics of algorithms.

Efficiency: Algorithms can perform tasks quickly and accurately, making them an essential tool for tasks that require a lot of calculations or data processing.

Consistency: Algorithms are repeatable and produce consistent results every time they are executed. This is important when dealing with large amounts of data or complex processes.

Scalability: Algorithms can be scaled up to handle large datasets or complex problems, making them useful for applications requiring large data processing.

Automation: Algorithms can automate repetitive tasks, reducing the need for human intervention and freeing up time for other tasks.

Standardisation: Algorithms can be standardised and shared among different teams or organisations, making it easier for people to collaborate and share knowledge.

10.3.2 What is an AI Algorithm?

An Artificial Intelligence algorithm is the programming that tells the computer how to learn to operate independently. It is much more complex than what most people learn about in algebra. A complex set of rules drives AI programs, determining their steps and learning ability, we can say that without an algorithm, Artificial Intelligence would not exist. "Algorithms will power the systems, but the human touch, the insight and the journalist's judgement will be at a premium, (Charlie Beckett, 2019).

Types of AI Algorithms: The key differences between algorithms are in how they are trained and how they function. Under those categories, there are dozens of different algorithms. The three major types of AI algorithms are *Supervised learning*, *Unsupervised learning*, and *Reinforcement learning*.

Supervised learning: It uses labelled data to predict outcomes for other data. It works by taking in clearly labelled data while being trained and using that to learn and grow. A team of dedicated experts evaluates and reviews the results. Supervised learning comes from comparing a student's learning in the presence of a teacher or expert.

Unsupervised learning: Unsupervised learning algorithms use unlabelled data to create models and evaluate the relationships between different data points to give more insight into the data. In unsupervised and supervised learning, it can be used for classification and pattern recognition. A collection of AI algorithms that mimic the functions of a human brain is called *Neural Networks*.

Reinforcement learning usually comprises two major parts: an agent that performs an action and the environment in which the action is performed. The cycle begins when the environment sends the agent a "state" signal. That queues the agent to perform a specific action within the environment. Once the action is completed, the environment sends a "reward" signal to the agent, informing it of what happened so that the agent can update and evaluate its last action. Then, with that new information, it can act again. That cycle repeats until the environment sends a termination signal. Therefore, reinforcement learning algorithms learn by taking in feedback from the result of their actions. This is typically in the form of a "reward" (Tableau).

10.3.3 How do AI Algorithms Work?

AI algorithms are, by nature, more complex than general algorithms. AI algorithms work by taking in training data that helps the algorithm to learn. The main difference between various types of AI algorithms is how data is acquired and labelled marks. An AI algorithm takes in training data (labelled or unlabelled, supplied by developers, or acquired by the program itself) and uses that information to learn and grow. Then, it completes its tasks, using the training data as a basis. Some types of AI algorithms can be taught to learn independently and take in new data to change and refine their process. Others will need the intervention of a programmer to streamline.

10.3.4 Strengths and Weaknesses of Algorithms

Strengths of Algorithms are:

1. **Easy to understand:** Since it is a stepwise representation of a solution to a given problem, it is easy to understand.
 2. **Language Independent:** It is not dependent on any programming language, so anyone can easily understand it.
 3. **Debug / Error Finding:** Every step is independent / in a flow, so it will be easy to spot and fix the error.
 4. **Sub-Problems:** It is written in a flow, so now the programmer can divide the tasks, which makes them easier to code.
- Weaknesses of Algorithms are: Creating efficient algorithms is time-consuming and requires good logical skills. It is not very nice to show branching and looping in algorithms.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What is an AI algorithm?

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2. What is Machine Learning?

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3. How is machine data generated?

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4. What are the characteristics of Algorithms?

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5. What are the types of AI Algorithms?

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6. What are the strengths and weaknesses of AI algorithms?

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10.4 ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN JOURNALISM

10.4.1 What is Artificial Intelligence?

Artificial intelligence (AI) has become a significant part of journalism. AI is an intelligent machine which can work like humans. Whatever task you give the machine can perform by learning from experience and using the available data. AI is the simulation of human intelligence processes by Machines. It can mimic human intelligence, behaviour patterns, or any other living entity. AI combines various sciences like computer, mathematics, psychology, philosophy, neuroscience, linguistics, operations research, economics, and logic.

10.4.2 What is Automated Journalism?

Automated journalism, also known as algorithmic journalism or robot journalism, is a term that attempts to describe modern technological processes that have infiltrated the journalistic profession, such as news articles generated by computer programs. There are four main fields of application for automated journalism: automated content production, Data Mining, news dissemination and content optimisation.

10.4.3 Journalism AI Project

The journalism think-tank Polis, based in the Department of Media and Communications at the London School of Economics and Political Science, started a project called "JournalismAI" in 2019, and the Google News Initiative supports it. It aims to inform media organisations about the opportunities offered by AI-powered technologies and to foster debate about the editorial, ethical, and financial implications of using AI in journalism. This report is based on a survey of 71 news organisations in 32 different countries regarding artificial intelligence and associated technologies. A wide range of journalists working with AI answered questions about their understanding of AI, how it was used in their newsrooms, and their views on the wider potential and risks for the news industry. Charlie Beckett's (2019) journalism AI report *New powers and new responsibilities: A global survey of journalism and artificial Intelligence* revealed that the newsrooms identified six key areas where AI might make a difference to their organisation's ethics, editorial policy and practice:

Key areas of journalism where AI might make a difference

Economics: Making cuts from AI-generated savings could lower editorial standards. Reinvestments could instead be used to improve journalism quality and effectiveness.

Algorithmic Bias: Bad use of data could lead to editorial mistakes such as inaccuracy or distortion and even discrimination against certain social groups or views.

Misinformation/Filter Bubbles: AI can help spread 'fake news'. Crude use of personalisation can make confirmation biases or conflict worse. However, well-managed AI can help counter misinformation and improve the quality of public information.

Enhancement of editorial decisions and transparency: AI can help correct old newsroom biases and increase the diversity of stories and audiences. It can promote transparency around the use of AI and journalism in general.

Balancing human and artificial intelligence: It is vital that augmented journalism retains human values and even enhances the value of human judgement and creativity.

The role of technology companies: There is concern over the power of 'Big Tech' as competitors and about their control of research and product development. They were also seen as a source of innovation, tools, and systems. There is a need for more transparency, dialogue, and support for journalism from technology companies.

10.4.4 AI-powered Writing

AI-powered writing is a service that uses artificial intelligence to write content. Renowned author Stephen Marche warns that AI-generated writing is poised to fundamentally automate the world of writing. "Whatever field you are in, if it uses language, it is about to be transformed". "The changes that are coming are fundamental to every method of speaking and writing that presently exists."

Mayur Bhatt, marketing head of SEO Services Guru, observes, "It is only a matter of time before algorithms can write articles on any topic and for any target group." Joe Dysart (2022) said that Artificial Intelligence and automated robots in 2022 have churned out countless news articles, business reports, opinion pieces, sports stories, ad slogans, newsletters, press releases – and more – on a daily basis.

Robots driven by AI are here to serve humanity. When AI writing machines show up in the workplace, it is no wonder writers across the globe are fretting. These robots will do the drudgery work. Writers will be freed up to engage in more interesting, in-depth, and creative work. Robots have already come for the job of writers.

10.4.5 The Rise of AI News Presenters

What is an AI anchor? Anchor AI collects, tracks, and categorises what is said and who said it and then converts that data into usable and actionable information. Automatically generated, searchable action items keep vital points in mind, ensuring you never miss a beat (Nivash Jeevanandam, 2023).

Who is the first AI news anchor? China's state-run *Xinhua* media group unveiled the first AI news presenter in 2018. *Xinhua* introduces the AI presenter called *Qiu Hao*. The presenter's voice and appearance were modelled on an actual presenter. A few months later, the agency introduced a female news anchor, *Xin Xiaomeng*. Both of them claimed to provide objective and unbiased news coverage and cater to their audiences' diverse linguistic and cultural needs.

India Today's leading newsgroup, *India Today*, launched its own AI anchor, *Sana*, on the *Aaj Tak* news channel in 2023. *Sana* was designed to be a "woman" who could deliver news 24 hours a day and 365 days a year. *Sana*'s creators claimed that she had the professional skills of a "thousand presenters" and could speak about any topic.

The most recent addition to the AI news presenter family is *Fedha*, who was revealed by *Kuwait News*, the Gulf region's first English-language daily, in April 2023. *Fedha* is powered by artificial intelligence (AI) and has a Kuwaiti accent and facial features representing the country's diverse population. *Fedha*'s developers wanted to create an AI presenter reflecting Kuwait's culture and identity. Even though this sounds exciting, AI news presenters are not real people but simulations that cannot replace the human touch and emotion that make journalism meaningful (No Brain Technology, 2023).

10.4.6 Technological Skills of Journalists

According to the JournalismAI report (2019), media professionals should be trained in the following three skills:

- Automatic tagging/entity extraction for news gathering
- Machine-generated content for news production
- Personalisation/recommendation engines for news distribution

1. ***Automatic tagging/entity extraction for news gathering:*** Automatic tagging is an emerging capability generating growing interest like other AI technologies. It refers to the automated application of tags to describe content. Tags are a kind of content metadata. Tags identify what the content is about according to a defined list of taxonomy terms, which are standardised descriptive keywords. Because content tags use standardised terms, they differ from social media hashtags, which are normally user-defined. Auto-tagging is a feature that automatically adds a parameter to your URLs to help you track offline conversions and report on your ad performance using website tracking programs like Google Analytics.

Entity extraction is a text analysis technique (TAT) that uses Natural Language Processing (NLP) to automatically pull-out specific data from unstructured text and classify it according to predefined categories. These categories are named entities, the words or phrases that represent a noun. For example, you download Microsoft's AI BuilderLab.zip application and provide the sample data referring to feedback or conversations related to travel. You intend to use the entity extraction AI model to extract and identify entities related to places, persons, organisations, dates, time, and Location Types. After going through a few steps, you will be able to import the data (Michael Andrews, 2022, August 9).

2. ***Machine-generated content for news production:*** Machine-generated content (also called Machine-generated data) is information created without human interaction due to a computer process or application activity. When you enter data manually, it is not recognised to be machine generated. Machine data include application log files, call detail records, clickstream data associated with user web activities, data files, system configuration files, alerts, and tickets.

Machine-to-machine (M2M) and human-to-machine (H2M) interactions generate machine data. Machine data is generated continuously by every processor-based system (including HVAC controllers, smart electrical metres, GPS devices, and RFID tags) and many consumer-oriented systems (mobile devices, automobiles, and medical devices with embedded electronic devices). In recent years, the increase of machine data has surged due to the expansion of mobile devices, virtual servers and desktops, and cloud-based services (Janani, 2021).

3. ***Personalisation/recommendation engines for news distribution:*** A personalisation engine is generally used by businesses to collect and

analyse customer behaviour and data. The tools often utilise content experience and A/B testing software to generate a fully customised content creation and distribution cycle. Digital marketing teams use personalisation engines to increase lead conversion rates, improve marketing campaigns and optimise customer satisfaction, thereby improving business results.

Artificial intelligence is necessary for effective personalisation engines. AI clusters and classifies data as it enters the system, making it easy to discover during queries. Natural language processing functions, like named entity recognition, should also be applied -- to determine if data contains the names of people, places or products that may provide valuable insights. In order to qualify as a personalisation engine, content must produce and deliver customised user experiences through various channels (Kate Brush, 2020).

10.4.7 What is AI Ethics and Why is it Important?

AI ethics refers to the concerns that stakeholders (from engineers to government officials) must examine to ensure the responsible development and application of artificial intelligence technology. It entails developing a safe, secure, humane, and ecologically sustainable AI approach. AI systems prioritise data security. Ethically constructed AI systems include data governance and model management systems. Privacy and protecting AI principles contribute to data security (Nivash Jeevanandam, 2023). Though AI gives journalists more power, editorial and ethical responsibilities have increased equally.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What is Artificial intelligence (AI)?

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2. What is Automated Journalism?

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3. List out key areas where AI might make a difference to their organisations.?

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4. What does AI-powered writing mean?

5. Who are the first AI news anchors, and what is their origin?

6. What are the skills of AI tools prerequisite for a future journalist?

7. What does AI ethics mean?

10.5 ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE TOOLS

10.5.1 *ChatGPT*: Solve Anything!

You might have heard about the buzzword ChatGPT. It is a conversational artificial intelligence platform developed by a San Francisco-based American research lab called Open AI and released on November 30, 2022. Since then, ChatGPT has become the fastest-growing application of all time. GPT stands for Generative Pre-trained Transformer, a pre-fixed chat that lets you get all you are looking for in a simple chat. The original release of ChatGPT was based on GPT-3.5. A version based on GPT-4, the newest OpenAI model, was released on March 14, 2023, and is available for paid subscribers on a limited basis. There are positive and negative opinions of the scholars and media outlets on ChatGPT.

Positive views: Kevin Roose of *The New York Times* labelled it "the best artificial intelligence chatbot ever released to the general public". Samantha Lock of *The Guardian* noted that it could generate "impressively detailed"

and "human-like" text. Technology writer Dan Gillmor used ChatGPT on a student assignment, found its generated text was on par with what a good student would deliver, and opined that "academia has some very serious issues to confront". Alex Kantrowitz of *Slate* magazine lauded ChatGPT's pushback to questions related to Nazi Germany.

Negative Views: In February 2023, *Time* magazine placed a screenshot of a conversation with ChatGPT on its cover, writing that "The AI arms race is changing everything" and "The AI Arms Race Is On. Start Worrying". The Chinese government instructed Chinese tech companies not to offer access to ChatGPT services on their platforms. In an opinion piece for the *New York Times*, Nathan Sanders and Bruce Schneier wrote that ChatGPT "hijacks democracy". Scholars like Noam Chomsky, Ian Roberts and Jeffrey Watumull criticised this technology. They concluded: "Given these systems' amorality, faux science and linguistic incompetence, we can only laugh or cry at their popularity."

10.5.2 *Jasper AI: Write Anything*

Like ChatGPT, Jasper Chat is a new, more conversational way of interacting with generative AI. It is a content creator or AI text generator. Instead of thinking in commands or strict prompts, you can converse with AI and refine responses with each engagement. OpenAI, which creates ChatGPT, is a partner of Jasper's, and GPT 3.5 is one of the language models you use in this platform. Jasper Chat differs from Chat GPT because it is built for business use cases like marketing, sales and more. Nevertheless, both interfaces offer a way to make AI much more accessible to the audiences they serve.

10.5.3 *Quillbot: Rewrite Anything*

QuillBot is an AI-powered paraphrasing tool, and it will enhance your writing. The paraphrasing tool is designed to ensure you use the right ones. You can use QuillBot's online Paraphraser to rephrase any text in various ways. The product will improve your fluency while ensuring you have the appropriate vocabulary, tone, and style for any occasion. Your words are the matter; enter your text into the input box, and the AI will work with you to create the best paraphrase.

10.5.4 *Jenni AI: Write Essays*

Jenni.ai is a new type of AI writing assistant that generates original and unique content using the latest advancements in artificial intelligence. Jenni.ai is an online software; you can fight blank page syndrome and create content ideas or even entire blog posts at lightning speed. As per Jenni.ai, their solution is the most advanced AI writing solution on the market (Artturijalli, 2022). The main feature of Jenni.ai is to help generate written content. Jenni can help you with content: Blog posts, Essays, Emails, Personal statements, Stories and Speeches. Here are some of the main features of Jenni.ai:

- **AI autocompletion:** Jenni uses AI to complete your sentences if you get stuck. Besides, you can ask Jenni to generate entire blog posts.

- **Plagiarism-free content:** There is a built-in plagiarism checker in Jenni.ai. This ensures that the AI-generated content is never copied from someone else.
- **Citations:** Jenni.ai will find citations to back up facts by trustworthy resources.
- **Text transformations:** You can rephrase or change the sentences with Jenni.ai.

10.5.5 Copy AI: Copywriting

Writing effective copy is a challenging feat for everyone. Copy.ai is an AI content generator that delivers premium results in seconds, built on top of the world's most advanced AI language model. CopyAI is helping thousands of people turbo-charge their creativity. For using AI copywriters, choose the format you want the AI writer to generate copy for, along with your desired style or tone. Generate AI copy with a click, scored and sorted by predicted performance. Have the AI writer generate variations you like and add your own copy variations to see how they compare.

10.5.6 Murf.ai: Text to Speech

Murf is a text-to-speech tool. It provides a complete toolkit for making voiceover videos. You can combine images, videos, music, adjust timing, etc. Murf offers high-quality, natural-sounding AI voices for your projects. For example, you want to create a corporate training module and explainer videos for your staff. In that case, Murf offers both male and female voices that will enhance the quality of your corporate training module. You can add a well-timed AI voiceover to your videos using Murf's AI technology, making them more engaging. Unlike most video editing software, Murf does not require video editing skills. It gives you complete control over your process and allows you to directly convert your home recordings or scripts into voiceovers. AI text-to-speech is time and cost-effective while retaining the quality of your voiceovers.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. What is ChatGPT, and who developed it?

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2. What are the AI writing tools?

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3. What is the purpose of the Murf.ai tool?

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10.6 IMPACT OF AI ON FUTURE JOURNALISM

After you see the harsh reality of the power of algorithms and AI, the question will arise in your mind of whether machines will take over journalism in the future. In this regard, Bathke (2017) says, "No, the robots will not take over journalism. Yes, the machines might soon be able to do much routine journalism labour. However, the reality and potential of artificial intelligence, machine learning and data processing are to give journalists new powers of discovery, creation and connection.

Mayur Bhatt (2022) says, "The fear is always that the profession of a journalist disappears completely. However, AI can also be very helpful in journalism. This is particularly likely to apply to investigative journalism. Algorithms can help to link similar information and extract individual features from general data. It is about recognising patterns and being able to make hypotheses."

News partnerships director, The Associated Press, one of the earliest pioneers of AI-generated newswriting, Lisa Gibbs, said, "The work of journalism is creative. "It is about curiosity; it is about storytelling; it is about digging and holding governments accountable. "It is critical thinking, it is judgment — and that is where we want our journalists spending their energy," (Dysart, Joe. 2022).

Thus, the hope is that journalists will be algorithmically turbo-charged, capable of using their human skills in new and more effective ways. AI could also transform newsrooms from linear production lines into networked information and engagement hubs that give journalists the structures to advance the news industry into the data-driven age.

Though the future impact of AI is uncertain, it is clear that it has the potential for wide-ranging and profound influence on how journalism is made and consumed. We hope AI will help newsrooms make decisions around strategy and think proactively about the ethical and editorial challenges and the potential implications of adopting these new technologies.

Check Your Progress 5

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1. Do you think machines will take over the job of journalism in the future?

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2. What is the Impact of Artificial Intelligence on future journalism?

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10.7 LET US SUM UP

In this Unit, we took up emerging media technologies and the new media, which are often in a constant state of refinement and innovation. 21st-century phenomena of Algorithms and Artificial Intelligence are poised to change the field of journalism. Applying algorithms and AI will surely help newsrooms in the process of news gathering, creating and distributing digital media content. While applying the innovative practices and usage of AI robots, thinking positively about the ethical and editorial challenges and the potential implications of adopting these new technologies in media is an immediate concern.

We looked at skills of AI tools prerequisite for journalists' future, such as automatic tagging/ entity extraction for news gathering, machine-generated content for news production and personalisation/recommendation engines for news distribution. Journalists are supposed to be transformed from traditional abilities to digital AI-supported journalistic practices. Apart from discussing AI news presenters/anchors, we learnt about a few of the artificial Intelligence tools that are important for the purpose. However, plenty of other AI applications and tools help journalists, for which there is a need to keep searching for upcoming AI tools.

To sum up, when the news industry is fighting for economic sustainability and public trust and relevance, AI technology offers immense possibilities in the media sector, boosting the economy of the media industry and upholding the truth. AI can help the public cope with a world of news overload and misinformation and connect them conveniently to credible content that is relevant, useful and stimulating for their lives. AI technologies may lessen the burden on media professionals and can free up journalists to work on creating better journalism. Journalism AI can provide information fast, making journalism's future brighter.

10.8 UNIT END EXERCISES

Activity - 1

S. No.	AI Application/Tool	Utility
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		

We are sure you must be a techno-savvy. Think of some of the various AI-related applications and tools you like on the Internet and try to identify their utility.

Activity - 2

Learn how to use ChatGPT for various purposes. You need to create an account on the OpenAI website chat.openai.com and register for an account with an email address. Accept ChatGPT terms. Once you have logged into your OpenAI account on the ChatGPT side of the website, read through the terms and disclosures for ChatGPT and click on Next. Click on Done when you reach the last one. Then, start writing with it and ask the language model any burning questions you may have and list out what kind of answers you get, how many are right, and how many are wrong answers.

Questions in ChatGPT	Right Answers	Wrong answers

Activity - 3

Identify the technological skills of Journalists that are prerequisites to work with AI robots and in AI newsrooms. Discuss these skills with your friends, develop a questionnaire tool on Google form and distribute it to various working journalists to check whether the working journalists have these skills.

Activity - 4

Watch news bulletins daily for a week, presented by AI Robot *Sana* on *the Aaj Tak* news channel *India Today* (discussed in the Unit). *Sana*'s creators claimed that she had the professional skills of a "thousand presenters" and could speak about any topic, observe these credentials and write a review on it.

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Activity - 5

Since Murf offers high-quality, natural-sounding AI voices for any project (discussed in the Unit), prepare a multimedia digital story/project on any topic you like, using the Murf AI tool combining images, videos, music, adjusting timing, etc., using male/female voices.

Activity - 6

You must read the book *New Power, New Responsibilities: A Global Survey of Journalism and Artificial Intelligence* written by Charlie Beckett (2019, November) in the JournalismAI report. Give your views on the book in about 150 words, highlighting its usefulness for mass communication students. At this point, feel free to worry about the accuracy of what you have written.

Activity - 7

Identify various AI applications/tools related to content creation, keeping in view the strengths and limitations of each application/tool. Suggest appropriate applications and tools for the journalists working in media outlets.

Activity - 8

Collect ten articles published in a newspaper or magazine on the theme of Algorithms and AI for journalism, discussed in the Unit. Identify the various issues highlighted by the authors for a holistic understanding of algorithms and artificial intelligence.

10.9 KEYWORDS

Technological determinism: Theory that assumes that a society's technology progresses by following its own internal logic of efficiency while determining the development of the social structure and cultural values. The term 'technological determinism' was coined by American economist and sociologist Thorstein Veblen (1857-1929)

New media: New media refers to computational media that share material online and through computers. It inspires new ways of thinking about older media and refashioning traditional media. When old media contains technologies that enable digital generative or interactive processes, then broadcast television programmes, feature programmes, feature films, magazines, newspapers and books are considered to be new media.

Algorithms: It is a finite sequence of rigorous instructions, typically used to solve a class of specific problems or to perform a computation.

Artificial Intelligence: An intelligence demonstrated by machines, as opposed to the intelligence of humans and other animals.

AI-powered writing: AI-powered writing is a service that uses artificial

intelligence to write content.

ChatGPT: ChatGPT is an artificial intelligence chatbot developed by OpenAI and released in November 2022. It is built on top of OpenAI's GPT-3.5 and GPT-4 families of large language models.

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10.11 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. Emerging media are communication formats or channels that are in the process of becoming part of society's communication architecture.
2. Technological determinism is that a society's technology progresses by following its own internal logic of efficiency while determining the development of the social structure and cultural values.
3. Old media are broadcast radio, television programmes, feature films, newspapers, magazines, and books as independent media channels. At the same time, New media is the media channels that contain technologies that enable digital generative and/or interactive processes.

Check Your Progress 2

1. An AI algorithm is the programming that tells the computer how to learn to operate independently.
2. Machine Learning is the study of computer algorithms that can improve automatically through experience and by the use of data. Machine learning algorithms build a model based on sample data, known as training data, to make predictions or decisions without being explicitly programmed.
3. Machine data generate: 1. Machine-to-machine (M2M) interactions, 2. Human-to-machine (H2M) interactions.
4. Characteristics of AI Algorithms:

Efficiency: Algorithms can perform tasks quickly and accurately

Consistency: Algorithms are repeatable and produce consistent results every time

Scalability: Algorithms can be scaled up to handle large datasets or complex problems

Automation: Algorithms can automate repetitive tasks

Standardisation: Algorithms can be standardised and shared among different teams

5. Types of AI Algorithms:

There are three major categories of AI algorithms:

- Supervised learning
- Unsupervised learning
- Reinforcement learning

6. Advantages of AI algorithms

- Easy to understand
- Language Independent
- Debug / Error Finding
- Sub-Problems, easier to code

Disadvantages of AI algorithms

- Require logical skills
- Time-consuming
- Disgusting to show branching and looping

Check Your Progress 3

1. AI is an intelligent machine which can work like humans. Whatever task you give the machine can perform by learning from experience and using the available data. AI is the simulation of human intelligence processes by machines. It can mimic human intelligence, behaviour patterns, or other living entities.
2. Automated journalism, also known as algorithmic journalism or robot journalism, is a term that attempts to describe modern technological processes that have infiltrated the journalistic profession, such as news articles generated by computer programs.
3. Key areas where AI might make a difference to their organisations:

Economics: Reinvestments could be used to improve journalism quality and effectiveness.

Algorithmic Bias: Avoid discrimination against certain social groups.

Misinformation/Filter Bubbles: Well-managed AI can help counter misinformation

Enhancement of editorial decisions and transparency: AI can help

correct old newsroom biases and increase the diversity of stories and audiences.

Balancing human and artificial intelligence: Augmented journalism must retain human values

Technology companies: There is a need for more transparency, dialogue, and support for journalism from technology companies.

4. AI-powered writing means a service that uses artificial intelligence to write content. AI-generated writing is poised to automate the world of writing fundamentally.
5. China's state-run *Xinhua* media group unveiled the first AI news presenter in 2018. *Xinhua* introduces the AI presenter called *Qiu Hao*. A few months later, the agency introduced a female news anchor, *Xin Xiaomeng*. India Today's leading newsgroup, *India Today*, launched its own AI anchor, *Sana*, on the *Aaj Tak* news channel in 2023. The most recent addition to the AI news presenter family is *Fedha*, who was revealed by *Kuwait News*, the Gulf region's first English-language daily, in April 2023.
6. AI-tools prerequisite for a future journalist:
 - Automatic tagging/entity extraction for news gathering
 - Machine-generated content for news production
 - Personalisation/recommendation engines for news distribution
7. AI ethics refers to the concerns that stakeholders, from engineers to government officials, must examine to ensure the responsible development and application of artificial intelligence technology.

Check Your Progress 4

1. ChatGPT and its developer

ChatGPT is a pre-fixed chat that lets you get everything you want in a simple chat. It is a conversational artificial intelligence platform developed by a San Francisco-based American research lab called OpenAI and released on November 30, 2022. GPT stand for Generative Pre-trained Transformer.

2. AI writing tools

Jasper AI: Jasper Chat is a new, more conversational way of interacting with generative AI. It is a content creator or AI text generator.

Quillbot: QuillBot is an AI-powered paraphrasing tool that will enhance your writing. Your words matter, and the paraphrasing tool is designed to ensure you use the right ones.

Jenni AI: is a new type of AI writing assistant that generates original and unique content using the latest advancements in artificial intelligence. **Jenni.ai is an online software;** you can fight blank page syndrome and generate content ideas or even entire blog posts at lightning speed.

Copy AI: Copy.ai is an AI content generator that delivers premium results in seconds, built on top of the world's most advanced AI language model. CopyAI is helping thousands of people turbo-charge their creativity.

3. **Murf.ai tool:** Murf is a text-to-speech tool. It provides a complete toolkit for making voiceover videos. You can combine images, videos, music, adjust timing, etc. Murf offers high-quality, natural-sounding AI voices for your projects.

Check Your Progress 5

1. No, the robots are not going to take over journalism. The machines might soon be able to do much routine journalism labour, but fear is always that the profession of a journalist will disappear completely. However, AI can also be very helpful in journalism.
2. The future impact of AI is uncertain, but it has the potential for wide-ranging and profound influence on how journalism is made and consumed. We hope AI will help newsrooms make decisions around strategy and think proactively about the ethical and editorial challenges and the potential implications of adopting these new technologies.

